Reference-Guided Merge Tree Maps: Quantifying Position–Topology Trade-offs Supplementary Material

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This supplement provides derivations, algorithms, data protocols, complete metrics, controls, and reproducibility details. The six-sequence planar temporal evaluation (342 frames), independent mirror-motion control (64 frames), original-grid Tangaroa and Cylinder sequences (201 and 102 volumes), static Nucleon slice, and reconstructed Benzene potential (21 static sections) are separate experimental populations. The 744-hour Storms overview is a visualization-only experiment. Standard-metric re-evaluation uses the same fixed configurations and is reported separately from the retained primary anchor-based metrics.

S1–S3 establish the formal model, planar protocols, and validation; S4 retains additional visuals; S5 records reproducibility. S6 details Tangaroa, S7 audits the event cases and baselines, S8 records figure coordinates and aggregations, S9 documents the additional inputs, and S10 collects complete visual comparisons. The main figures retain their source arrays and scalar scales; full-resolution profiles, rather than figure previews, supply the reported errors.

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S1 Formal Derivations and Algorithms

The main paper presents one function-based construction algorithm, combining reference setup, diagnosis, hierarchy selection, layout, and scalar barriers. Its workflow figure supplies the visual overview. This section retains the full interval constraints, closed-form costs, frontier definition, display-grid recurrence, and detailed planar construction; S2 specifies the quadratic objective, and S6 records the large-tree bounds and candidate-search protocol.

S1.1 Assumptions and feasible layouts

A rooted tree T with leaves $1,\dots,n$; *branching* nodes have ≥ 2 children (unary chains contracted); $p(v)$ is the parent of a non-root branching node v and S_v its leaf set. Join-tree convention: f strictly increases along root-ward paths; leaves are minima (split trees: negate f). Leaf i has reference $q_i \in \mathbb{R}$, width $w_i > 0$, eccentricity radius $h_i = \rho w_i/2$ with $\rho \in [0,1]$; gap $g > 0$; canvas $[a, a+L]$. A layout (π, z, u) satisfies (D) $z_y - z_x \geq (w_x + w_y)/2 + g$ for π-consecutive x, y; (C) $a + w_i/2 \leq z_i \leq a + L - w_i/2$; (E) $|u_i - z_i| \leq h_i$. Assume $\sum_i w_i + (n-1)g \leq L$ so the feasible set is nonempty. $\Pi(T)$: orders in which every S_v is contiguous. $\tau(\pi) = \min_{z,u} \max_i |u_i - q_i|$ subject to (D)(C)(E); $\tau^*(T) = \min_{\pi \in \Pi(T)} \tau(\pi)$; $\tau_{\text{free}} = \min_{\pi \in S_n} \tau(\pi)$.

S1.2 Fixed order

Lemma S1.1 (Anchor elimination)**.** *For fixed z,*

$$\min_u \max_i |u_i - q_i| = \max_i \max(0, |z_i - q_i| - h_i).$$

Hence for $\tau \geq 0$ an admissible u with error $\leq \tau$ exists iff $|z_i - q_i| \leq \tau + h_i$ for all i.

Proof. (E) is separable; $\min_{u \in [z_i - h_i, z_i + h_i]} |u - q_i|$ is the distance from q_i to that interval. □

Lemma S1.2 (Chains with box windows)**.** *Let $[\ell_k, r_k]$, $k = 1..n$, $s_k \geq 0$, $S_{ij} = \sum_{k=i}^{j-1} s_k$. There is z with $z_k \in [\ell_k, r_k]$ and $z_{k+1} - z_k \geq s_k$ iff $\ell_i + S_{ij} \leq r_j$ for all $i \leq j$.*

Proof. ($\Rightarrow$) $z_j \geq z_i + S_{ij} \geq \ell_i + S_{ij}$ and $z_j \leq r_j$. ($\Leftarrow$) $z_j := \max_{i \leq j}(\ell_i + S_{ij})$ satisfies $z_j \geq \ell_j$, $z_j \leq r_j$, and $z_{j+1} \geq z_j + s_j$. □

Proposition S1.3 (Closed form)**.** *Renumber along π; $s_k = (w_k + w_{k+1})/2 + g$, $D_k = \sum_{m<k} w_m + w_k/2 + (k-1)g$, $E_k = \sum_{m>k} w_m + w_k/2 + (n-k)g$. If $\sum_i w_i + (n-1)g > L$ the order is infeasible; otherwise*

$$\tau(\pi) = \max\Big\{0,\ \max_{i<j} \tfrac{q_i - q_j + S_{ij} - h_i - h_j}{2},\ \max_k (a + D_k - q_k - h_k),\ \max_k (q_k - h_k - a - L + E_k)\Big\}.$$

Proof. By Lemma S1.1, τ is feasible iff some z satisfies (D)(C) and $z_k \in [\ell_k, r_k]$ with $\ell_k = \max(a + w_k/2, q_k - \tau - h_k)$, $r_k = \min(a + L - w_k/2, q_k + \tau + h_k)$. By Lemma S1.2 this holds iff $\ell_i + S_{ij} \leq r_j$ for all $i \leq j$, i.e. four families of inequalities. (i) $q_i - \tau - h_i + S_{ij} \leq q_j + \tau + h_j$. (ii) $q_i - \tau - h_i + S_{ij} \leq a + L - w_j/2$; since $S_{ij} + w_j/2$ increases in j (increment $w_{j+1} + g$), the binding case is $j = n$ where it equals E_i. (iii) $a + w_i/2 + S_{ij} \leq q_j + \tau + h_j$; since $w_i/2 + S_{ij}$ decreases in i (decrement $w_i + g$), the binding case is $i = 1$ where it equals D_j. (iv) $a + w_i/2 + S_{ij} \leq a + L - w_j/2$, independent of τ; binding at $i = 1, j = n$: capacity. All τ-dependent constraints are lower bounds on τ. □

S1.3 Hierarchy

Lemma S1.4. *$\pi \in \Pi(T)$ iff π arises by permuting, at every node, the blocks of its children and recursing. Thus $|\Pi(T)| = \prod_v \deg(v)!$.*

Proof. Induction on height: the children's leaf sets of the root are contiguous, disjoint, and cover all leaves, so π is a concatenation of these blocks in some order; recurse. □

Proposition S1.5 (Exactness)**.** *$\tau^*(T)$ is attained and is the exact optimum of the model.*

Proof. $\Pi(T)$ is finite and each $\tau(\pi)$ is attained (Prop. S1.3). □

Proposition S1.6 (Monotonicity and decomposition)**.** *Let* $\mathrm{flat}(T,V)$ *delete the non-root internal nodes in V, attaching their children to the nearest undeleted ancestor. (i) $V \subseteq V' \Rightarrow \Pi(\mathrm{flat}(T,V)) \subseteq \Pi(\mathrm{flat}(T,V'))$, hence τ^* is non-increasing. (ii) Deleting all non-root internal nodes gives τ_{free}. (iii) $H := \tau^*(T) - \tau_{\mathrm{free}} \geq 0$.*

Proof. Surviving nodes keep their leaf sets, so an order making more leaf sets contiguous makes a subset of them contiguous. The star tree only constrains the root. □

Proposition S1.7 (Witness triples)**.** *If $i, j \in S_v$, $k \notin S_v$ and $q_i < q_k < q_j$, then $\tau^*(T) \geq \frac{1}{2}\min(q_k - q_i,\ q_j - q_k)$.*

Proof. In any $\pi \in \Pi(T)$, k precedes both i, j or follows both. Anchors are ordered as π: if x precedes y then $u_x \leq z_x + w_x/2 < z_y - w_y/2 \leq u_y$. If k precedes i, $(q_k - u_k) + (u_i - q_i) \geq q_k - q_i$, so one error is $\geq (q_k - q_i)/2$; symmetrically if k follows j. □

S1.4 Exact algorithm at display resolution

Pixels of width λ, canvas N pixels, integer widths W_i, gap G. Leaf i occupies $[s_i, s_i + W_i)$, centre $s_i + W_i/2$; consecutive x, y: $s_y \geq s_x + W_x + G$; $0 \leq s_i \leq N - W_i$. By Lemma S1.1 error $\leq \tau$ iff $s_i \in [lo_i(\tau), hi_i(\tau)]$ with $lo_i = \max(0, \lceil q_i - \tau - h_i - W_i/2 \rceil)$, $hi_i = \min(N - W_i, \lfloor q_i + \tau + h_i - W_i/2 \rfloor)$. For a subtree S and integer x, let $E_S(x)$ be the minimum over legal orders of S and window-feasible placements with all starts $\geq x$ of $s_{\mathrm{last}} + W_{\mathrm{last}} + G$ (∞ if none).

Lemma S1.8 (Earliest placement)**.** *For a fixed order and lower bound x, the greedy placement $s_1 = \max(x, lo_1)$, $s_{k+1} = \max(s_k + W_k + G, lo_{k+1})$ is feasible iff any placement is, and minimises every s_k.*

Proof. Induction: any feasible placement has $s_1 \geq \max(x, lo_1)$ and $s_{k+1} \geq s_k + W_k + G \geq s_k^{\mathrm{greedy}} + W_k + G$, $s_{k+1} \geq lo_{k+1}$. If greedy exceeds some hi_k, so does every placement. □

Theorem S1.9 (Exact DP)**.** *For a leaf, $E_i(x) = \max(x, lo_i) + W_i + G$ if $\max(x, lo_i) \leq hi_i$, else ∞. For a node with children $C_1..C_m$,*

$$E_S = \min_{\sigma} E_{C_{\sigma(m)}} \circ \cdots \circ E_{C_{\sigma(1)}}.$$

This is computed as $\min(E_B \circ E_A, E_A \circ E_B)$ for $m = 2$ and by subset DP $F_\emptyset = \mathrm{id}$, $F_M = \min_{c \in M} E_c \circ F_{M \setminus c}$ in general. τ is feasible iff $E_{\mathrm{root}}(0) < \infty$; feasibility is monotone in τ, so bisection yields τ^*_{disc}. Cost: $O(nN)$ per test for binary trees; $O(2^m mN)$ per m-ary node.

Proof. Each E_S is non-decreasing (a minimum over a feasible set that shrinks as x grows); compositions and pointwise minima preserve this. By Lemma S1.4 a legal order of S is a permutation of child blocks with legal orders inside. For a fixed child permutation, by Lemma S1.8 and monotonicity, the only information a block passes to the next is its earliest next start, and a smaller value never hurts; hence composing the children's optimal E functions is optimal for that permutation, and the minimum over permutations gives E_S (induction on height). Windows widen with τ. □

Proposition S1.10 (Discretisation)**.** *If widths and gap are integer multiples of λ and the canvas is grid-aligned, then $0 \leq \tau^*_{\mathrm{disc}} - \tau^*_{\mathrm{cont}} \leq \lambda/2$.*

Proof. Discrete layouts are continuous layouts. Conversely round every start of a continuous optimum by $x \mapsto \lfloor x + \frac{1}{2} \rfloor$ (translation-equivariant; not ties-to-even): it is monotone and $\lfloor x + d + \frac{1}{2} \rfloor = \lfloor x + \frac{1}{2} \rfloor + d$ for integer d, so (D) and (C) survive; each centre moves by $\leq \lambda/2$. □

Proposition S1.11 (Certified lower bound)**.** *For arbitrary real widths and gap, let the relaxed discrete problem use $\lfloor w_i/\lambda \rfloor$, $\lfloor g/\lambda \rfloor$ and the original slacks h_i. Then $\tau^*_{\mathrm{cont}} \geq \tau^*_{\mathrm{disc,relax}} - \lambda/2$.*

Proof. Every layout feasible for the original problem is feasible for the relaxed continuous problem (smaller widths and gap only loosen (D)(C); (E) is unchanged), so $\tau^*_{\mathrm{relax}} \leq \tau^*_{\mathrm{cont}}$; Proposition S1.10 gives $\tau^*_{\mathrm{disc,relax}} \leq \tau^*_{\mathrm{relax}} + \lambda/2$. □

Remark S1.12. Theorem S1.9 is pseudo-polynomial in the resolution N and exponential in the degree of m-ary nodes; bisection yields the optimum to a tolerance. The scalable DP computes the certificate; choosing a layout inside the budget still enumerates candidate orders.

S1.5 Topological cost and the fundamental trade-off

For any continuous function ψ on the display interval with leaf anchors u_i define $m_\psi(i,j) = \max_{[u_i,u_j]} \psi$ (join tree), $m_T(i,j) = f(\mathrm{lca}_T(i,j))$ and $d_{\mathrm{top}} = \max_{i\neq j} |m_\psi(i,j) - m_T(i,j)|$. For one leaf, set pairwise error and δ^* to zero; empty pair maxima impose no constraint. Use the standard upward root extension when interpreting this metric as a labelled interleaving distance.

Lemma S1.13. *If u_i, u_j are local minima of ψ, the smallest α at which they lie in one component of $\{\psi \le \alpha\}$ is $m_\psi(i,j)$.*

Proof. Components of sublevel sets on a line are intervals. □

Proposition S1.14. *If the minima of ψ are exactly the n labelled leaves with $\psi(u_i) = f(i)$, then d_{top} equals the ℓ_∞ distance between the cophenetic vectors of T and of the merge tree of ψ, which is the labelled interleaving distance (Munch–Stefanou).*

Proof. By Lemma S1.13 $m_\psi(i,j)$ is the height of $\mathrm{lca}(i,j)$ in the merge tree of ψ; diagonal (leaf) entries agree. □

Theorem S1.15 (Topological price of non-contiguity)**.** *If the leaf set S_v of a non-root node v is not contiguous in the anchor order of a 1-D map, then for every ψ: $d_{\mathrm{top}} \ge \gamma_v/2$ with $\gamma_v = f(p(v)) - f(v)$.*

Proof. Pick $i, j \in S_v$, $k \notin S_v$ with u_k between u_i and u_j. Then $[u_i,u_k] \subseteq [u_i,u_j]$ gives $m_\psi(i,k) \le m_\psi(i,j)$; in T, $m_T(i,j) \le f(v)$ and $m_T(i,k) \ge f(p(v))$. Hence $\gamma_v \le m_T(i,k) - m_T(i,j) = [m_T(i,k) - m_\psi(i,k)] + [m_\psi(i,k) - m_\psi(i,j)] + [m_\psi(i,j) - m_T(i,j)] \le 2d_{\mathrm{top}}$. □

Remark S1.16. Theorem S1.15 needs no assumption that anchors are extrema; only Proposition S1.14 (the interleaving interpretation) does. γ_v is an adjacent merge-height gap, not birth–death persistence. The LCA filling is not generally optimal; the optimal filling (Proposition S1.19) is exact.

Remark S1.17 (Tightness). For $T = ((i,j)_v, k)$ with $f(k) \le f(v) + \gamma_v/2$ and anchors ordered i,k,j, choose ψ with $\max_{[u_i,u_k]} \psi = \max_{[u_k,u_j]} \psi = f(v) + \gamma_v/2$; then every pair has error exactly $\gamma_v/2$.

Corollary S1.18 (Lower frontier)**.** *Let $\Phi_T(\delta) = \tau^*(\mathrm{flat}(T, \{v : \gamma_v \le 2\delta\}))$. Every layout satisfying (D)(C)(E), with any filling, has $\max_i |u_i - q_i| \ge \Phi_T(d_{\mathrm{top}})$.*

Proof. Let V be the set of nodes whose leaf sets are non-contiguous. By Theorem S1.15, $V \subseteq W := \{v : \gamma_v \le 2d_{\mathrm{top}}\}$. All nodes outside V are contiguous, so by Lemma S1.4 $\pi \in \Pi(\mathrm{flat}(T,V)) \subseteq \Pi(\mathrm{flat}(T,W))$ (Prop. S1.6). Hence $\max_i |u_i - q_i| \ge \tau(\pi) \ge \Phi_T(d_{\mathrm{top}})$. □

S1.5.1 Optimal filling and the attainable frontier

Fix a leaf order π and anchors $u_{\pi_1} < \cdots < u_{\pi_n}$. A filling is *value-preserving* if it shows the true leaf values at the anchors, $\psi(u_k) = f(k)$ (join convention; negate f for split trees). Write leaves by map position, $M_{ij} = f(\mathrm{lca}_T(i,j))$ for $i < j$, and

$$C_k = \min_{i \le k < j} M_{ij}, \qquad \ell_k = \max(f(k), f(k+1)), \qquad k = 1, \ldots, n-1.$$

Proposition S1.19 (Optimal filling)**.** *Over value-preserving fillings, the infimum is*

$$\inf_\psi d_{\mathrm{top}} = \delta^*(\pi) = \max\Big\{0,\ \max_k (\ell_k - C_k),\ \tfrac{1}{2}\max_{i<j}\big(M_{ij} - \max_{i\le k<j} C_k\big)\Big\}. \tag{S1}$$

It is attained by the barrier filling $b_k = C_k + \delta^*(\pi)$, where b_k is the maximum of ψ on $[u_k, u_{k+1}]$. If every anchor must remain a strict local minimum, barriers with $b_k = \ell_k$ are raised by $\varepsilon > 0$ and $\delta^*(\pi)$ is approached as $\varepsilon \to 0$ (for $T = ((i,j)_1,k)_6$ with $f = 0, 0.2, 5$ and order i,k,j, the infimum 4 is not attained by a strict-minimum filling). $\delta^*(\pi) = 0$ iff $\pi \in \Pi(T)$.

Proof. For any ψ, let b_k be its maximum on $[u_k, u_{k+1}]$. Then $m_\psi(i,j) = \max(f(i),\dots,f(j),b_i,\dots,b_{j-1})$. Since ψ is continuous and u_k, u_{k+1} lie at the ends, $b_k \geq \ell_k$, so $m_\psi(i,j) = \max_{i\leq k<j} b_k$. Hence $d_{\text{top}} \leq \delta$ iff (a) $b_k \leq M_{ij} + \delta$ for all $i \leq k < j$, i.e. $b_k \leq C_k + \delta$, and (b) $\max_{i\leq k<j} b_k \geq M_{ij} - \delta$. Constraint (b) only improves when barriers rise, so δ is feasible iff $b_k = C_k + \delta$ satisfies $b_k \geq \ell_k$ and (b), i.e. iff $\delta \geq \ell_k - C_k$ for all k and $\max_{i\leq k<j} C_k + \delta \geq M_{ij} - \delta$ for all $i < j$. A filling realising any admissible barriers exists (e.g. piecewise linear through $(u_k, f(k))$ and one peak b_k per gap). If $\pi \in \Pi(T)$, the ultrametric property gives $M_{ij} = \max_{i\leq k<j} M_{k,k+1}$ and $C_k = M_{k,k+1} \geq \ell_k$, so $\delta^* = 0$; conversely $\delta^* = 0$ implies $d_{\text{top}} = 0$, and Theorem S1.15 forces every S_v to be contiguous. □

Remark S1.20. The term $\ell_k - C_k$ is new relative to Theorem S1.15: a shallow extremum placed between two leaves that merge deeply raises their 1-D merge level to at least its own value, whatever the filling. The fixed-leaf term can dominate the adjacent-merge-gap bound; it must therefore be included when evaluating a value-preserving filling. If fillings may also change the values shown at the anchors, as the labelled interleaving distance with diagonal entries permits, the term becomes $\frac{1}{2}(\ell_k - C_k)$: for $T = ((i,j)_v, k)$ with $f = 0, 0, 5$, merges at 1 and 6, and order i, k, j, $\delta^* = 4$ for value-preserving fillings but $2.5 = \gamma_v/2$ otherwise.

Theorem S1.21 (Exact position–topology frontier)**.** *For a value-preserving layout with order π, $\max_i |u_i - q_i| \geq \tau(\pi)$ and $d_{\text{top}} \geq \delta^*(\pi)$, and the bounds are attained simultaneously if non-strict extrema are allowed. If every anchor must remain a strict local minimum, the positional bound is attained and the topological bound can be approached arbitrarily closely. Thus the closure of the achievable set has lower envelope*

$$F_T(\delta) = \min\{\tau(\pi) :\ \pi \in S_n,\ \delta^*(\pi) \leq \delta\}, \qquad \Phi_T(\delta) \leq F_T(\delta),$$

and $F_T(0) = \tau^*(T)$, $F_T(\infty) = \tau_{\text{free}}$.

Proof. Positions enter only through $\tau(\pi)$ (Proposition S1.3) and the filling only through π and the anchor values (Proposition S1.19); the optimal positions for π and the barrier filling can be combined because the barrier filling only prescribes values between consecutive anchors, which remain separated by the gap $g > 0$. $\Phi_T \leq F_T$ is Corollary S1.18. □

Remark S1.22. F_T is computed by enumerating S_n ($n \leq 11$ in the exact-frontier study). The DP for Φ_T is practical only when the flattened tree has bounded child degree: flattening a binary tree can create an n-ary root. Neither this DP nor the exact frontier is claimed to scale to arbitrary relaxed hierarchies.

S1.6 Certifying projected distance changes

Let $D_q(t) = |q_i(t) - q_j(t)|$ and $D_u(t) = |u_i(t) - u_j(t)|$ for features present at times t and s. Put $e_i(t) = |u_i(t) - q_i(t)|$.

Proposition S1.23 (Projected distance-change margin)**.** *The difference between the displayed and reference distance changes satisfies*

$$|(D_u(s) - D_u(t)) - (D_q(s) - D_q(t))| \leq e_i(t) + e_j(t) + e_i(s) + e_j(s) =: E_{ij}(t,s).$$

If $|D_u(s) - D_u(t)| > E_{ij}(t,s) + \eta$, the reference change has the same sign and magnitude greater than η. A uniform per-frame positional budget gives $E_{ij}(t,s) \leq 2(B_t + B_s)$.

Proof. The reverse triangle inequality gives $|D_u(t) - D_q(t)| \leq e_i(t) + e_j(t)$. Apply it at both times and then apply the triangle inequality to the difference. □

Remark S1.24. This is an upper-error guarantee about projected coordinates, not two-dimensional distances or human judgements. It uses achieved errors or feasible upper budgets; a small optimal lower certificate alone cannot justify trusting a particular layout.

Proposition S1.25 (Width-free certificate)**.** *Define*

$$\tau_{\text{pt}}(\pi) = \max\{0, \max_{i \text{ before } j \text{ in } \pi} (q_i - q_j)/2\},$$
$$\tau^*_{\text{pt}}(T) = \min_{\pi\in\Pi(T)} \tau_{\text{pt}}(\pi).$$

For every 1-D map whose anchor order lies in $\Pi(T)$, with any widths, gaps, or eccentricity, and every non-decreasing calibration c of the map axis onto the reference axis, $\max_i |c(u_i) - q_i| \geq \tau^*_{\text{pt}}(T)$; moreover $\tau^*_{\text{pt}} \leq \tau^*$.

Proof. If i precedes j and $q_i > q_j$, then $c(u_i) \le c(u_j)$, so $|c(u_i) - q_i| + |c(u_j) - q_j| \ge q_i - q_j$. The bound $\tau^*_{\mathrm{pt}} \le \tau^*$ holds because Proposition S1.3's pair terms with $w = g = h = 0$ are dropped constraints. For distinct anchor coordinates, attainment for a fixed order follows by setting $c(u_k) = \frac{1}{2}(\max_{i \preceq k} q_i + \min_{j \succeq k} q_j)$. □

S1.7 Display certificate pseudocode

Algorithm 1 Certificate τ^* at display resolution (Theorem S1.9).

Require: hierarchy T; pixel widths W_i, gap G, references q_i, radii h_i; N pixels; tolerance ε

function EARLIEST(S, τ) ▷ array over starts $x = 0, \dots, N$
  if S is a leaf i **then**
    $lo_i \leftarrow \max(0, \lceil q_i - \tau - h_i - W_i/2 \rceil)$, $hi_i \leftarrow \min(N - W_i, \lfloor q_i + \tau + h_i - W_i/2 \rfloor)$
    return $x \mapsto \max(x, lo_i) + W_i + G$ if $\max(x, lo_i) \le hi_i$, else ∞
  $E_c \leftarrow$ EARLIEST(c, τ) for every child c of S
  $F_\emptyset \leftarrow$ id; $F_M \leftarrow \min_{c \in M} E_c \circ F_{M \setminus \{c\}}$ for all subsets M of children
  return $F_{\text{all children}}$ ▷ binary: $\min(E_B \circ E_A, E_A \circ E_B)$

$\tau^* \leftarrow$ smallest τ with EARLIEST(root, τ)$(0) < \infty$, by bisection to ε

S1.8 Construction pseudocode

Algorithm 2 RG-MTM construction with optional relaxation.

Require: augmented input trees T_t with arc samples, extrema R_i, supports A_i; feature tracks; mode
  Parameters: conflict threshold θ; eligible merge gap κ; positional slack β

$d \leftarrow$ principal direction of tracked extremum displacements; $q_i \leftarrow \langle R_i, d \rangle$ scaled to the axis
for $t = 1, \dots, K$ **do**
  $\tau^* \leftarrow \min_{\pi \in \Pi(T_t)} \tau(\pi)$; $\tau_{\text{free}} \leftarrow \min_{\pi \in S_n} \tau(\pi)$; $H_t \leftarrow \tau^* - \tau_{\text{free}}$
  $T' \leftarrow T_t$
  if relaxed mode and $H_t > \theta$ **then** ▷ threshold and prune
    $W \leftarrow \{v : v \text{ is non-root internal, } \gamma_v \le \kappa\}$; $b_0 \leftarrow \widehat{\tau}(\mathrm{flat}(T_t, W))$
    for $v \in W$ by decreasing γ_v **do**
      if $\widehat{\tau}(\mathrm{flat}(T_t, W \setminus \{v\})) \le b_0 +$ half a pixel **then**
        $W \leftarrow W \setminus \{v\}$
    $T' \leftarrow \mathrm{flat}(T_t, W)$
  $B_t \leftarrow \tau^*(T') + \beta$ ▷ error budget
  $(\pi, z, u) \leftarrow$ over $\pi \in \Pi(T')$ with $\tau(\pi) \le B_t$, minimize distance stress, reference error, eccentricity, and motion residual w.r.t. $t-1$ subject to (D)(C)(E) and $|u_i - q_i| \le B_t$ ▷ one QP per order
  $(s, e, \alpha) \leftarrow$ discretize intervals and anchors on the fixed canvas
  $v_t \leftarrow \mathrm{FullDomainFill}(T_t, \pi, s, e, \alpha)$ ▷ original augmented tree
  if relaxed mode **then**
    compute $C_k, \delta^*(\pi)$ against T_t; correct barriers (Prop. S1.19)
  report τ^*, H_t, $\max_i |u_i - q_i|$, and measured raster merge error
Assemble $\mathscr{V} = [v_1 \ \cdots \ v_K]$ using shared scalar colours; annotate achieved errors

S2 Data and Construction Protocols

Notation and pipeline interfaces. Table S1 separates source geometry, display geometry, and scalar values. Time indices are omitted only in single-frame derivations. In the filling derivation, i, j denote positions in π; elsewhere they identify leaves. K counts frames, while the native ST-MTM extent parameter is written K_{native}.

Table S1: Notation used throughout the construction.

Symbols	Meaning and role
F_t, Ω, K	Processed scalar field, common spatial domain, and number of frames.
T_t, T_t', ψ_t	Augmented source tree, ordering hierarchy after optional flattening, and displayed scalar profile.
$e_i^t\ (R_i^t), G_i^t, \mu_i^t\ (A_i^t)$	Extremum position, support centroid, and support area or volume; parentheses give legacy protocol symbols. The position and centroid need not coincide.
$\mathscr{M}_t, S_R, d$	Previous/current leaf correspondences, global motion scatter, and shared unit reference direction.
q_i, u_i, z_i	Reference target, actual extremum anchor, and display-interval centre, in common length units.
w_i, h_i, g, a, L	Interval width, anchor radius, minimum gap, canvas origin, and fixed extent.
$\pi, \Pi(T)$	All-leaf display permutation and the orders that preserve subtree contiguity.
$\tau^*, \tau_{\text{free}}, H$	Best tree-consistent position error, hierarchy-free packing/boundary optimum, and their difference.
θ, β, B_t	Conflict trigger, extra positional slack, and achieved-error upper budget; length units.
γ_v, κ	Adjacent merge gap and eligible-gap threshold; scalar units, not an error guarantee.
M_{ij}, C_k, b_k	Original merge level for display-ranked leaves, spanning-pair gap bound, and displayed barrier.
$\delta^*(\pi), d_{\text{top}}$	Best filling error for an order and measured error of a rendered column; scalar units.
$P, D_{\text{mean}}, D_{\max}$	NROE (normalized reference-order error) and frame-mean/worst-frame NMLE (normalized merge-level error); reported as percentages.
$N, \alpha_i, v_t, \mathscr{V}$	Raster length, integer anchor pixel, one filled column, and $N \times K$ temporal array.

Table S2: Evaluated fields. Leaf counts refer to the processed extrema and merge trees.

Data	Period / construction	Frames	Grid	Leaves	Tree	Smoothing
Storms	1999-11-17–2000-01-14	118	49×49	1–8	Join	250 km
Wildfires	Nov.–Dec. 2019	30	64×64	6–11	Split	50.7 km
OLR	2024-06-01–2024-07-30	60	49×49	2–8	Join	500 km
PM2.5	2000-01-01–2000-01-30	30	49×49	1–5	Split	100 km
Ring	Synthetic expansion	40	14×14	1–7	Split	–
Gaussian	Synthetic motion	64	64×64	3–4	Split	–

Six sequences, 342 frames. Storms is sampled every 12 hours; Wildfires uses two-day aggregates; OLR and PM2.5 supply one sample per day. Smoothing denotes the fixed Gaussian scale. January PM2.5 is exploratory.

Storms (ERA5 mean sea-level pressure). We retain ERA5 mean sea-level pressure for 1999-11-17–2000-01-14, sampled every 12 hours over the North Atlantic and Europe (25–80°N, 40°W–50°E) [5]. A 49×49 equal-area grid and 250 km Gaussian smoothing define join-tree minima. Smoothing is performed on a buffered domain; only extrema of that extended field inside the window are retained, and other cropped basins are filled to their spill levels. These are processed-field minima, not independently validated cyclone centres.

Wildfires (fire radiative power). The Wildfires sequence uses Australian fire observations on 10-km source cells from the November–December 2019 sequence [4]. Starting on 2019-11-01, 60 daily observations are summed into 30 two-day frames, whose start dates end on 2019-12-29. Active source cells are accumulated on a 64×64 layout grid, followed by $\log(1 + \text{FRP})$. A weak smooth background removes zero plateaus. The smallest common scale from the declared ladder keeping at most twelve maxima is 2.5 layout cells (50.7169 km); evaluated frames contain six to eleven leaves. Split-tree maxima describe processed fire-intensity structures, rather than independently tracked individual fires.

Radiation fields. Daily NOAA OLR CDR (PSL Ver01Rev02) [9] covers 2024-06-01–2024-07-30 over 15°S–20°N, 60–150°E. Join-tree minima represent low radiation, not validated convective systems. A 49×49 equal-area grid uses five-cell buffers, priority-flood cropping, and no added imputation; a global-extremum fallback is logged. The fixed ladder (100, 150, 200, 250, 350, 500, 700, 1000 km) selects the smallest common scale with at most eight extrema, independently of performance: 500 km. Source hashes and preprocessing trials are recorded.

PM2.5 concentration. The integrated China dataset (V2, 10-km grid) [3] supplies 30 fields, 2000-01-01–2000-01-30, over 28–38°N, 102–114°E. Files carry 10:30 timestamps without an explicit averaging interval. The same buffered

grid and eight-extremum rule select 100 km smoothing for split-tree maxima. Values retain $\mu g\,m^{-3}$ units. Metadata record upstream linear-then-nearest filling; we add no imputation. Per-file hashes identify the local snapshot. January was chosen for the main display after the exploratory seasonal comparison; its performance is a selected case, not an independent validation.

Ring. We reproduce the archived TMTM author generator and workspace for the Ring control [4, 8]: 40 frames on the endpoint-inclusive 14×14 grid over $[0,210]^2$, without added smoothing, interpolation or noise. The generator changes a Gaussian radial profile over time. The extracted split tree has one to seven maxima because a sampled ring is not a single isolated extremum. The source commit, generator/workspace hashes and float32 property values are recorded in `experiments/ring/dataset.py`. The main RG-MTM comparison uses the same automatic fixed-direction reference as the real sequences; the analytic ring radius is not silently substituted for that reference.

Gaussian (local variant). The local construction uses a 64×64 grid on $[0,120]^2$ for 64 frames. Gaussian centres at $(25,25)$ and $(85,85)$ are fixed; a third moves from $(115,60)$ toward $(75,35)$ during the first 80% of the sequence and then stops. A connecting ridge controls the hierarchy between the fixed features. The input has three prescribed blobs but three to four extracted maxima, so a prescribed centre is not identical to a retained tree leaf. We reuse the name Gaussian from ST-MTM for this local variant. The construction is inspired by the motivation in ST-MTM [2], not a claim to reproduce its 128×128 input. Current two-step, 2%-diagonal thresholds yield no clear geometric motion events; order and geometry metrics remain evaluable.

Suite boundaries. The six sequences total 342 frames. The archived Storms 2013/14 sequence (source identifier `ERA5-2014`) is an independent season, not an alias of the main Storms sequence. Additional PM2.5 months are selection/robustness controls. The 64-frame perpendicular-bisector experiment is a separate synthetic control; none is added to the main total without an explicit protocol change. All methods share processed fields and overlap-based leaf matching, which isolates layout differences within this extraction but does not validate physical identities. For Wildfires, the active 10-km source cells are binned into a square 64×64 field. Consecutive pairs of days are summed before applying $\log(1+\mathrm{FRP})$. The candidate Gaussian scales are 1, 1.5, 2, 2.5, 3, 4, 5, 6, and 8 cells. The selected 2.5-cell scale corresponds to 50.7 km; the processed field has 6–11 maxima per frame. A broad 16-cell Gaussian background with coefficient 10^{-3} of the field range removes zero plateaus. This background changes the field on which the tree is computed; the reported topology is the topology of that processed field.

OLR and PM2.5 preprocessing uses a spherical Lambert cylindrical equal-area projection, a 49×49 interior grid, and five-cell buffers. The priority-flood boundary operation can change cropped samples, so it is part of the field definition rather than a display-only operation. Source hashes, scale trials, fallback flags, and per-frame modification statistics appear in the protocol JSON files. The main quantitative comparisons share these processed fields exactly. No claim is made about preserving the topology of the unprocessed observations.

S2.1 Synthetic fields and correspondences

Ring uses the archived author generator associated with TMTM [8]. Its 40 frames sample an expanding radial Gaussian on a 14×14 endpoint-inclusive grid over $[0,210]^2$:

$$f_t(x,y) = p_t \exp\left[-\frac{1}{2}\left(\frac{\|(x,y)-c\| - r_t}{s_t}\right)^2\right]. \tag{S2}$$

The declared parameters are $c = (30.4, 40.6)$, $p_t = 1 + 0.3t$, $r_t = 1.94t$, and $s_t = 12.16 + 0.05t$, with $t = 0,\ldots,39$. The adapter uses their archived float32 property representations. No smoothing, added noise, interpolation, or random seed is used. The adapter records generator/workspace hashes and transposes the source x,y arrays to time,y,x pipeline order. Grid discretization can create several extrema in a radial field, explaining the observed 1–7 leaves.

The Gaussian control contains 64 frames with two fixed centres and one moving centre. The stored construction has fixed centres at $(25,25)$ and $(85,85)$, and a third centre starting at $(115,60)$, moving toward $(75,35)$ before stopping. The field is sampled on 64×64 points over $[0,120]^2$. Each centre contributes a Gaussian of standard deviation 7 with amplitudes 1, 0.95, and 1.05 respectively. A ridge of amplitude 0.5 and width 9 connects the two fixed centres, computed from distance to their line segment. The moving centre is $c_3(t) = (115,60) + [(75,35) - (115,60)]\min(1, t/51.2)$. This construction is defined in `analysis/task_reference.py`; centre metadata are retained in `replicate_gaussian.json`. Extracted leaves, including grid-induced effects, rather than the intended centre count, define the comparison. There are 3–4 leaves per frame and no clear motion events at the default secondary evaluation setting.

All comparison methods share feature IDs, supports, merge trees, and frame correspondences from the common extraction/tracking code. Tracks are computational associations between extrema, not manual annotations. The automatic reference uses the same matched displacements that enter the evaluation. The protocol provides no held-out direction-fitting split; fixed axes assess direction sensitivity without establishing predictive generalization.

S2.2 Layout objective and operating parameters

For candidate order π, let $\mathscr{P}_\pi = \{(\pi_r, \pi_s) : r < s\}$ and use matched leaf pairs $\mathscr{M}_t$ from the shared-reference construction in the main paper. Define

$$\begin{aligned} E_{\text{ref}} &= \frac{1}{n}\sum_i (u_i^t - q_i^t)^2, \\ E_{\text{dist}} &= \frac{1}{\max(1, |\mathscr{P}_\pi|)} \sum_{(i,j)\in\mathscr{P}_\pi} \left[(u_j^t - u_i^t) - \|G_j^t - G_i^t\|_2\right]^2, \\ E_{\text{motion}} &= \frac{1}{\max(1, |\mathscr{M}_t|)} \sum_{(j,i)\in\mathscr{M}_t} \left[(u_i^t - u_j^{t-1}) - (q_i^t - q_j^{t-1})\right]^2, \\ E_{\text{ecc}} &= \frac{1}{n}\sum_i (z_i^t - u_i^t)^2. \end{aligned} \tag{S3}$$

The evaluated solver weights these normalized terms by $4, 1, 0.5, 0.1$, respectively. Matches are unweighted in this construction. The indices j and i explicitly refer to the previous and current leaf, avoiding an assumption that frame-local IDs stay unchanged. All geometry and reference coordinates use the same length units. The quadratic programs obey the interval constraints and $|u_i - q_i| \le \tau^*(T_t') + \beta$. Motion penalizes deviation from the projected reference displacement, not movement itself. Unmatched features have no temporal term, and frames are optimized sequentially rather than jointly.

The global width scale assigns domain area to half the reference extent. The evaluated settings use $g = L/240$, $\rho = 0.5$, $\beta = L/120$, and $\theta = 0.02L$. Relaxation thresholds are 2%, 20%, and infinity of the sequence's processed scalar range. The heuristic score uses a 4096-pixel grid and a fixed half-pixel pruning tolerance; the final budget uses the continuous optimum. These parameters control computation and geometry; no perceptual calibration study establishes them as visibility thresholds.

S2.3 Baselines and metric compatibility

TMTM and ST-MTM preserve tree order; ST-MTM is reimplemented from its paper description [2], not compared through the original authors' executable. Native Hilbert/Morton retain every processed grid sample without refilling, using a minimal power-of-two square with exterior samples discarded. Curve orientation is fixed with x=column and y=row. Native scalar maxima/minima along a sample interval define pairwise merge errors. Optimal barrier filling is applied to RG-MTM relaxation and the packed-sort control. Thus a comparison concerns both ordering and each stated rendering protocol; it does not isolate the effect of ordering alone.

Packed sorting shares interval constraints and secondary objectives but removes hierarchy. Exact projection is a reference control without a rendered scalar topology, and its projected-coordinate error is zero by definition. Fixed-X is a robustness control. Main position comparisons permit monotone calibration and are optimistic order diagnostics; they cannot validate faithful 2-D distances or native pixel coordinates. Stable source-feature order resolves raster ties consistently. The order-only metric then allows a separate monotone coordinate for each tie-broken leaf, so it remains an optimistic lower diagnostic rather than an attained calibration of tied pixels.

S2.4 Exact baseline configuration

The shared forward ST-MTM runner uses temporal mode and Start=0. Except Ring, parameters are uniform pair weights, $r = 0.95$, temporal weight 0.5, size exponent $\alpha = 1$, minimum continuous anchor spacing 0.01, SLSQP tolerance 10^{-11}, and at most 2000 optimizer iterations. Its fixed leaf extent is $K_{\text{native}} = c_{\text{native}} \sum_i A_i(0)$, where c_{native} maps domain area to half the native canvas span. Ring uses the supplied preset: uniform weights, $K_{\text{native}} = 1$, $r = 0.95$,

temporal weight 1.5, $\alpha = 1$, spacing 10^{-3}, and tolerance 10^{-9}. These are our declared comparison settings, not the original preprint's complete real-data configurations.

Nominal ST-MTM lengths are 4096 pixels for Storms, OLR, and PM2.5; 2048 for Wildfires; 196 for Ring; and 1024 for Gaussian. Global scaling, padding, and rasterization follow the reimplemented skeleton/filling code. TMTM uses temporal overlap optimization and its native augmented sample order. The positional comparison does not use adaptive raster refinement; separate native-merge checks retain nominal-resolution diagnostics. The ST-MTM parameter-grid evidence is an exploratory control, rather than post hoc selection of the best baseline for every reported metric.

Feature correspondences use a maximum intersection-count Hungarian assignment of leaf supports, accepting positive overlaps only. New leaves receive new track identifiers. Tracks are shared across methods. This differs from manually validated physical trajectories, and overlapping time-window events can reuse the same tracks and frames.

S2.5 Shared-reference calculation

For matched extrema, let $\Delta R^t_{ji} = R^t_i - R^{t-1}_j$. The construction accumulates $S_R = \sum_{t=2}^{K} \sum_{(j,i)\in\mathscr{M}_t} \Delta R^t_{ji} (\Delta R^t_{ji})^\top$ and uses a unit principal eigenvector d. Its sign is oriented toward nonnegative total projected motion; a degenerate scatter requires a supplied direction. References are $q^t_i = \langle R^t_i, d\rangle$, with $a = \min_{x\in\Omega}\langle x, d\rangle$ and $L = \max_{x\in\Omega}\langle x, d\rangle - a$. These bounds are shared across frames. Widths satisfy $w^t_i = cA^t_i$, $c|\Omega| = L/2$, and $h^t_i = \rho w^t_i/2$.

S2.6 Metric roles and correspondence to ST-MTM

Our P, τ^*, and H are specific to the supplied reference and display constraints. The scalar comparison d_{top} uses labelled pairwise merge levels, with sequence summaries D (mean normalized framewise maximum) and $D_{\max}$ (sequence maximum). Motion error ME measures the fraction of clear approach/separation events that are reversed or missed at the declared window and thresholds; it is not participant accuracy.

ST-MTM [2] adopts scale-normalized stress (SNS) and trustworthiness (TW), and defines temporal displacement (TD) as a sum of displayed matched-feature displacements. Our stored stress uses the square root of normalized residuals and extremum locations, whereas its stated SNS uses squared residuals and feature centroids. The sequence mean stress cannot simply be squared to obtain mean SNS. Nearest-neighbor agreement is not TW, and our motion error is not TD. Supplement S3 separately recomputes SNS, TW, and canvas-normalized TD on the four fixed main configurations, using the definitions and valid-frame subsets stated there. TD also depends on display scale and the number of matched steps; a low value alone does not establish faithful source motion. Optimization and total times require uniform stage boundaries and repeated timings on common hardware, which the current evidence does not provide.

The main text compares four primary configurations (TMTM, ST-MTM, RG-MTM-P, RG-MTM-R) within each dataset; their main comparison is repeated in Supplement S3 for reference. Supplemental all-method tables retain native curves, Packed Sort, fixed-axis sensitivity, and exact-projection controls under their declared protocols. Bold minima are specific to each table's comparison population, not universal winners.

Main algorithm interfaces. Main Algorithm 1 combines temporal construction, hierarchy selection, and optimal scalar barriers in one function-based listing. Shared-reference estimation and the diagnosis interface are explained in main Section 5.1; the full display-grid recurrence and planar construction appear in Supplement S1. Continuous position budgets use legal-order enumeration at the suite's small feature counts; pruning uses rounded widths and gaps on a 4096-pixel grid and a fixed initial score b_0. Large-tree diagnosis retains bounds and layout evaluates at most four candidate QPs (S6). A grid optimum is not identified with an unrestricted continuous optimum.

S2.7 Full-domain filling and node semantics

The positional model operates on a contracted branching hierarchy, while the scalar renderer retains the augmented input tree and its regular samples. The implementation validates that each input sample belongs to one critical node or one arc, and that samples are monotone along each arc. This input ownership does not imply one-to-one ownership in the display: resampling can repeat or omit samples, paths can reuse arcs, and interpolation can introduce values absent from the input.

Relation to prior constructions. TMTM recursively allocates integer positions to the augmented tree's original samples, placing branching nodes between child blocks [8]. Our initial filling instead follows ST-MTM's leaf-interval and LCA-path construction (its Section 4.2) [2]. This is a borrowed rendering component, distinct from ST-MTM's ordering and layout optimizer. The certificate-guided order and optional minimax barrier correction are separate stages.

Table S3: How the complete augmented input contributes to a RG-MTM column.

Input entity	Display treatment
Every retained leaf	One extremum anchor and one support interval, including leaves outside a witness triple.
Leaf-arc regular sample	Uniformly resampled into the leaf interval; positions alternate outward from the anchor.
Branching merge node	Its LCA value separates adjacent child blocks in a legal order; all labelled leaf-pair levels encode the branching hierarchy.
Internal-arc sample	Resampled along an LCA path in an inter-interval gap, or along an outer root-to-leaf path.
Root and outer context	Border paths fill the remaining canvas. Finite root endpoints and unary tails are not guaranteed by pairwise merge fidelity.

Sampling conventions. Let α_i be an integer anchor and $[s_i, e_i]$ its interval. Place $f(i)$ at α_i and visit available positions $\alpha_i - 1, \alpha_i + 1, \alpha_i - 2, \alpha_i + 2, \ldots$, skipping positions outside the interval. Regular samples are ordered from the leaf toward its parent. Uniform resampling uses equally spaced indices and nearest-index rounding; an empty arc uses linear interpolation within its own endpoint values. Internal paths allocate integer sample counts proportional to arc sizes, distribute remaining pixels by largest fractional remainder, and concatenate samples in path order. Empty arcs receive a unit allocation weight. Deep–deep gaps first divide their non-LCA pixels proportionally between the two path sizes. Sibling gaps use quadratic interpolation toward the LCA, as in ST-MTM.

Algorithm 3 FullDomainFill: initial scalar column from the augmented input.

Require: Augmented input T; all leaves in order π; integer starts s, ends e, anchors α; pixel count N

Initialize $v[0, \ldots, N-1]$ as unassigned
for each leaf i in π **do**
    $v[\alpha_i] \leftarrow f(i)$
    Resample its leaf-arc values into alternating positions in $[s_i, e_i] \setminus \{\alpha_i\}$
for each consecutive pair (i, j) in π **do**
    $v \leftarrow \mathrm{lca}_T(i, j)$; obtain both paths above the already-filled leaf arcs
    if both leaves are direct children of v **then**
        Place $f(v)$ at the gap midpoint; quadratically interpolate both sides
    else if exactly one leaf is a direct child of v **then**
        Place $f(v)$ beside that leaf interval; resample the deeper path into the remainder
    else
        Split non-LCA pixels by path sizes; place $f(v)$ at the split; resample both paths
Fill both outer regions by resampling paths between the root and the outermost leaves
Verify every pixel is assigned and finite; **return** v

Correction uses the original tree. The flattened tree T' defines admissible orders only. Original merge levels M_{ij} and gap bounds C_k always come from T. In the relaxed mode, each open inter-anchor segment is clipped to its target barrier, and its existing maximum is raised to that barrier if needed. Anchors remain fixed. Split-tree processing negates values before filling/correction and negates them back afterwards. A positive clearance above adjacent leaf values keeps extrema strict when the theoretical optimum would produce a plateau. At least one interior pixel per inter-anchor segment is required; raster layouts that collapse the required separation are rejected or rendered at higher resolution.

Executed five-leaf example. the worked filling example uses $T = (((A_1, A_2)_2, B)_4, (C, D)_3)_8$, with all five leaf values zero and two regular samples on each arc. Here $A = \{A_1, A_2\}$ is a subtree, not a single leaf interval. A tree-consistent

order A_1, A_2, B, C, D has barriers $(2, 4, 8, 3)$ and zero pairwise error. For order A_1, A_2, C, B, D, the gap bounds are $C = (2, 4, 3, 3)$ and $\delta^* = 2.5$. Our minimax construction gives barriers $(4.5, 6.5, 5.5, 5.5)$ and measured maximum error 2.5.

Although A_1, A_2 remain consecutive, their merge moves from 2 to 4.5. Flattened ordering constraints, actually non-contiguous subtrees, and numerically changed merge levels are therefore different sets. This construction minimizes the largest leaf-pair error, not the number of modified relations. Protecting selected internal merge levels would define a different constrained filling problem and is not part of the evaluated method.

Tracing white and grey nodes to pixels. With anchors $(10, 30, 50, 70, 90)$ and four interval pixels on either side, white r_1 has value $2/3$ on the A_1 leaf arc and fills pixels $8, 9, 11, 12$. White r_2 has value $8/3$ on the internal A-to-parent arc and fills pixels 35–39 between A_2 and B. Grey S is the A_1–A_2 merge: $f(S) = 2$ occupies midpoint pixel 20. Thus white nodes supply resampled values, while grey nodes supply merge thresholds; neither receives a leaf's geographic anchor optimization. The exported trace verifies these values against actual pixels. Relaxed pixel 20 carries barrier 4.5, marking a changed relation rather than an unchanged source sample.

Verification and scope. Checks cover all 120 orders, ten leaf pairs, and independent gap-witness feasibility, including failure below the optimal positive budget. These synthetic validations add no real-data outcomes.

S2.8 Perpendicular-bisector control

This additional qualitative control is excluded from the six-sequence, 342-frame aggregates. For $t = 0, \ldots, 63$, the field is the sum of three isotropic Gaussians with standard deviation 4, amplitudes 1, 1.05, and 0.95, and centers $\mathsf{A} = (20, 20)$, $\mathsf{B}(t) = (40 + 40t/63, 80 - 40t/63)$, and $\mathsf{C} = (100, 100)$. We sample $[0, 120]^2$ on a 241×241 grid and extract augmented split trees without an added ridge. Every frame has three retained extrema. References use extracted grid extrema with $\mathbf{d} = (1, 0)$, not the analytic centers; grid spacing is 0.5. All 64 moving-feature references and all 64 achieved RG-MTM-R anchors are distinct, with no adjacent-frame repeats. Displayed trajectories are not smoothed. The two mirror endpoints have identical feature-distance matrices.

We retain the declared RG-MTM-R interval model and $\kappa = 0.20$. The observed pairwise merge-level error is zero in every frame for all three methods, so this experiment does not establish the necessity of relaxation. ST-MTM uses uniform weights, $K = 65$, $r = 0.95$, temporal weight 1.5, 4096 layout samples, and start timestep 0. RG-MTM-R also uses 4096 layout samples; TMTM retains the native sample permutation. Baseline map axes display internal coordinates. Only when measuring achieved positional error, each baseline receives one sequence-wide affine minimax calibration, allowing a global reflection but no framewise alignment. These errors must not be mixed with the main suite's order-only, monotone-calibrated P.

At the final frame, achieved positional errors are 16.67%, 16.67%, and 0.84% of L for TMTM, ST-MTM, and RG-MTM-R. Corresponding extrema-based stress-1 values are 0.053, 0.053, and 0.264; these are not ST-MTM's SNS. The control illustrates the additional information supplied by a fixed world reference, while disclosing the larger relative-distance stress. It is not a reproduction of the Gaussian figure in the ST-MTM paper.

Reproducibility. The experiment entry point is:
`experiments/publication2027/bisector_control.py`
Invoke it with arguments `bisector_highres` and `x`. Source fields, extracted positions, rendered maps, metrics, and source hashes are stored separately under `results/publication2027/bisector_control/`. The main figure reuses the compact rendering geometry and consistent feature-identity colours. Baseline-validation records describe a comparison of the original TMTM C++ greedy core with the local implementation on shared extracted trees; this is not a full Inviwo/TTK pipeline run.

S3 Additional Experiments and Validation

S3.1 Metric definitions and aggregation

The six-sequence evaluation distinguishes mathematical optima, achieved anchor displacement, measured raster errors and geometric motion outcomes. Each quantity is aggregated over its stated frame, feature or event population.

Normalized Reference-Order Error (NROE, P). For each frame, stable sorting of displayed anchors gives π. The point-model optimum is $\tau_{\mathrm{pt}}(\pi) = \frac{1}{2}\max\{0, \max_{r<s}(q_{\pi_r} - q_{\pi_s})\}$. Its temporal mean divided by the fixed sequence reference extent L is P. This removes widths, gaps, canvas bounds, and anchor radii, permitting a monotone calibration of distinct anchors. Stable tie-breaking assigns separate calibrated values to tied pixels; it is an optimistic diagnostic in that case. τ^*_{pt} minimizes this point cost over tree-consistent orders. Neither P nor τ^*_{pt} equals achieved reference displacement under the full interval model.

Achieved continuous displacement. For each retained feature-frame anchor define $e_i^t = |u_i^t - q_i^t|$. Report

$$E_{\mathrm{pool}} = \frac{\sum_t \sum_{i=1}^{n_t} e_i^t}{L \sum_t n_t}, \qquad E_\infty = \frac{\max_{t,i} e_i^t}{L}.$$

The original record also saves the pooled 95th percentile. Pooling weights frames by their retained feature count; the maximum weights no frame average. The full certificate τ_t^* instead bounds a frame's maximum, so it must not be compared directly with E_{pool}. Values here use continuous RG-MTM-P and RG-MTM-R anchors in reference units, before raster rounding. TMTM/ST-MTM native axes have different units and width models and are not assigned these direct-reference scores without an explicit calibration protocol. The achieved displacement values are reported in main Table 2; the accompanying numerical ledger also retains the pooled 95th percentile.

Normalized Merge-Level Error (NMLE, D). $\Delta_F = \max_{t,x} F_t(x) - \min_{t,x} F_t(x)$ is fixed per processed sequence. $D_t = d_{\mathrm{top}}(\psi_t, T_t)/\Delta_F$ measures the maximum pairwise labelled merge discrepancy in frame t. $D_{\mathrm{mean}} = K^{-1}\sum_t D_t$ averages frames; $D_{\max} = \max_t D_t$ is the worst frame. These are displayed as $\mathrm{NMLE}_{\mathrm{mean}}$ and $\mathrm{NMLE}_{\max}$; the symbols and saved numerical keys are unchanged. The fixed-label cophenetic basis follows existing labelled-tree metrics [10]; the experiment-specific normalization does not create a new unlabelled tree distance. One retained leaf gives zero pairwise error. For split trees the profile and original levels are negated before taking maxima. Native-curve barriers are measured on unchanged sample traversals. The revised main table uses `results/filling.json`'s measured optimal-filling summaries, while `results/eval_projection.json`'s `dstar` is the fixed-order closed-form optimum. Their small clearance/raster discrepancies are checked separately rather than silently identifying an optimum with a measurement.

Motion events and inference. A pair of tracks must be present at t and $t+k$; its true distance is the Euclidean distance between retained extrema. A clear event has distance change exceeding $\varepsilon_{2D} = 0.02\,\mathrm{diag}(\Omega)$ in magnitude. Main results fix $k = 2$. Displayed pair distance uses actual anchors and a method-specific threshold $\varepsilon_m = 0.02A_m$, where A_m is that method's full-sequence occupied anchor range. A nonzero opposite sign is a reversal; a change within $[-\varepsilon_m, \varepsilon_m]$ is a miss. ME is $(N_{\mathrm{rev}} + N_{\mathrm{miss}})/N_{\mathrm{clear}}$. The same true events are compared across methods, but the no-change thresholds depend on declared display ranges. If $N_{\mathrm{clear}} = 0$, error rates are undefined; they are not perfect scores. Motion labels are computational geometry, not participant responses. Projected-reference events use a different truth and threshold and must not be subtracted from 2D-truth rates to estimate projection loss.

Paired differences reuse the same events and employ circular moving-block bootstrap over time, with block length $k+2 = 4$ at the primary setting. The retained intervals are exploratory and have no multiplicity correction. Sparse selected PM2.5 events cannot establish a seasonal superiority claim; threshold/window and fixed-direction results remain controls.

Geometry and stability diagnostics. For unordered extremum pairs in a frame, set $a_{ij} = |u_i - u_j|$, $b_{ij} = \|R_i - R_j\|$, and $\alpha = (\sum a_{ij}b_{ij})/(\sum a_{ij}^2)$. The implementation averages

$$S_t = \sqrt{\frac{\sum_{i<j}(\alpha a_{ij} - b_{ij})^2}{\sum_{i<j} b_{ij}^2}}$$

over frames with at least three leaves. NN is the framewise mean agreement of each extremum's nearest neighbour under a and b, then averaged over the same frames. Stable array order resolves distance ties as implemented. Report the number of eligible frames; degenerate cases need explicit treatment if this protocol is extended beyond the present suite.

Flips counts sign changes in display order among pairs matched across consecutive frames, divided by the number of eligible matched pairs. J averages $|u_i^t - u_j^{t-1}|/A_m$ over individual matches. These stability diagnostics do not compare motion with a source target: true crossings or rapid source motion can increase either score. The QP's distance objective uses support centroids; the retained diagnostic S uses extremum locations. These choices answer different questions and are not silently interchanged.

ST-MTM's stated SNS has squared residuals and centroid distances, TW penalizes introduced neighbours by original-space ranks, and TD sums matched displacements. SNS and TW are adopted from prior work [11, 13], while ST-MTM specifies TD for its matched display positions. NN is not TW, J is not TD, and $(\text{mean}\, S_t)^2$ is not mean (S_t^2). The separate standard-metric re-evaluation below uses the required entities and aggregation without changing these historical diagnostics.

Source mapping. Order statistics use `results/final_performance.json`; motion and geometry use `results/eval_projection.json`; measured barrier costs use `results/filling.json`; achieved anchors use `results/replicate_<dataset>.json`'s `tradeoff` entries at caps 0 and 0.2, normalized by its `certificate.axis`. The main-paper ledger stores source hashes and unrounded values. No metric selection or bold-face ranking is inferred from a combined score.

Method-name mapping. RG-MTM means Reference-Guided Merge Tree Maps. RG-MTM-P is the hierarchy-preserving mode; RG-MTM-R is the relaxed mode. In the saved records, `A` denotes RG-MTM-P and `R 20%` denotes RG-MTM-R at $\kappa = 0.2\Delta_F$. Keys `R 2%` and `R inf` identify the other eligibility settings. The current repository is `02-RG-MTM`; historical `CD-MTM` labels identify the same relaxed method.

Table S4: Full interval-model certificates: temporal means normalized by reference extent.

Data	Frames	Leaves	Packing %	Hierarchy H %	Total τ^* %	Conflict frames
Storms	118	1–8	0.16	4.17	4.33	40/118
Wildfires	30	6–11	0.06	6.12	6.18	19/30
OLR	60	2–8	0.02	0.94	0.96	7/60
PM2.5	30	1–5	0.09	1.31	1.39	5/30
Ring	40	1–7	0.05	2.83	2.88	21/40
Gaussian	64	3–4	0.03	5.95	5.98	47/64

Total is $\overline{\tau^*}/L = \overline{\tau_{\text{free}}}/L + \overline{H}/L$. Conflicts use $H > 0.02L$. These are theoretical diagnostics of each input sequence, not competing method scores; no best-result ranking applies. Values are rounded independently.

Table S5: Motion-proxy error rates (%, ↓) with all seven main methods and RG-MTM-R's worst-frame scalar cost.

Data	Events	TMTM	ST-MTM	Hilbert	Morton	Packed	**RG-MTM-P (ours)**	**RG-MTM-R (ours)**	RG-MTM-R $D_{\max}$
Storms	104	47.1	41.3	46.2	44.2	**14.4**	23.1	18.3	26.1
Wildfires	112	39.3	35.7	50.0	48.2	33.0	32.1	**31.2**	19.6
OLR	56	44.6	21.4	48.2	46.4	**5.4**	**5.4**	**5.4**	33.6
PM2.5	7	71.4	42.9	42.9	**28.6**	42.9	42.9	**28.6**	9.5
Ring	124	64.5	34.7	38.7	25.0	**12.1**	31.5	12.9	12.3
Gaussian	0	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	10.0

This complete seven-method comparison complements the primary-method table in the main paper. Bold rates are row minima across the seven shown methods, with all ties; they are numerical minima, not significance claims. Events: common clear-event count at $k = 2$, 2% thresholds. Error = reversal + miss. RG-MTM-R $D_{\max}$ (%, ↓) is the relaxed methodś sequence-maximum merge error, not a motion score or cross-method ranking. RG-MTM-P and RG-MTM-R are our two modes. Gaussian has no clear events, so its rates are undefined. Sparse PM2.5 results are descriptive.

Table S6: Expanded numerical comparison. RG-MTM-P and RG-MTM-R are our tree-preserving/relaxed modes. Relaxed and packed-sort scalar entries use the saved analytical fixed-order optimum; the main table and filling checks use measured raster barriers. Bold values are minima within each dataset among rendered methods, including Fixed X; ties use unrounded records. Exact projection is a diagnostic control and is excluded from ranking because it has no scalar topology. Underlined P is best among zero-mean-D rows. Stress is Kruskal stress-1; error is reversal plus miss.

Data	Method	$P\downarrow$ %	Mean $D\downarrow$ %	Max $D\downarrow$ %	Stress $\downarrow$	Events	Error $\downarrow$ %
Storms	TMTM	19.23	**0.00**	**0.00**	0.317	104	47.1
Storms	ST-MTM	16.28	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.194**	104	41.3
Storms	Hilbert	6.75	22.76	49.41	0.326	104	46.2
Storms	Morton	16.42	25.22	63.63	0.352	104	44.2
Storms	**RG-MTM-P (ours)**	3.77	**0.00**	**0.00**	0.327	104	23.1
Storms	**RG-MTM-R (ours)**	1.16	1.47	26.07	0.308	104	18.3
Storms	Packed sort	**0.00**	6.18	58.66	0.299	104	**14.4**
Storms	Fixed X (control)	<u>3.77</u>	**0.00**	**0.00**	0.321	104	24.0
Storms	Exact projection	0.00	–	–	0.310	104	13.5
Wildfires	TMTM	29.30	**0.00**	**0.00**	0.458	112	39.3
Wildfires	ST-MTM	24.02	**0.00**	**0.00**	0.256	112	35.7
Wildfires	Hilbert	29.22	32.98	78.00	0.479	112	50.0
Wildfires	Morton	31.51	33.72	81.37	0.308	112	48.2
Wildfires	**RG-MTM-P (ours)**	<u>5.83</u>	**0.00**	**0.00**	0.261	112	32.1
Wildfires	**RG-MTM-R (ours)**	0.34	3.96	19.56	0.221	112	**31.2**
Wildfires	Packed sort	**0.00**	7.66	52.58	**0.219**	112	33.0
Wildfires	Fixed X (control)	31.22	**0.00**	**0.00**	0.397	112	36.6
Wildfires	Exact projection	0.00	–	–	0.227	112	26.8
OLR	TMTM	19.31	**0.00**	**0.00**	0.379	56	44.6
OLR	ST-MTM	17.21	**0.00**	**0.00**	0.097	56	21.4
OLR	Hilbert	32.50	41.13	78.60	0.358	56	48.2
OLR	Morton	30.76	47.35	76.95	0.528	56	46.4
OLR	**RG-MTM-P (ours)**	<u>0.89</u>	**0.00**	**0.00**	0.084	56	5.4
OLR	**RG-MTM-R (ours)**	**0.00**	1.10	33.56	0.074	56	5.4
OLR	Packed sort	**0.00**	1.10	33.56	0.074	56	5.4
OLR	Fixed X (control)	32.83	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.074**	56	**3.6**
OLR	Exact projection	0.00	–	–	0.081	56	7.1
PM2.5	TMTM	11.86	**0.00**	**0.00**	0.241	7	71.4
PM2.5	ST-MTM	11.30	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.137**	7	42.9
PM2.5	Hilbert	0.20	21.84	46.80	0.347	7	42.9
PM2.5	Morton	0.63	21.29	46.80	0.409	7	**28.6**
PM2.5	**RG-MTM-P (ours)**	<u>1.11</u>	**0.00**	**0.00**	0.508	7	42.9
PM2.5	**RG-MTM-R (ours)**	0.16	0.86	9.48	0.443	7	**28.6**
PM2.5	Packed sort	**0.00**	1.78	17.27	0.436	7	42.9
PM2.5	Fixed X (control)	7.71	**0.00**	**0.00**	0.323	7	**28.6**
PM2.5	Exact projection	0.00	–	–	0.464	7	57.1
Ring	TMTM	7.18	**0.00**	**0.00**	0.451	124	64.5
Ring	ST-MTM	10.39	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.316**	124	34.7
Ring	Hilbert	11.25	44.55	97.40	0.336	124	38.7
Ring	Morton	11.25	43.32	90.56	0.374	124	25.0
Ring	**RG-MTM-P (ours)**	<u>2.66</u>	**0.00**	**0.00**	0.402	124	31.5
Ring	**RG-MTM-R (ours)**	0.13	2.73	12.35	0.372	124	12.9
Ring	Packed sort	**0.00**	3.44	12.35	0.374	124	**12.1**
Ring	Fixed X (control)	10.87	**0.00**	**0.00**	0.442	124	37.1
Ring	Exact projection	0.00	–	–	0.389	124	13.7
Gaussian	TMTM	25.76	**0.00**	**0.00**	0.584	0	–
Gaussian	ST-MTM	25.76	**0.00**	**0.00**	0.291	0	–
Gaussian	Hilbert	25.76	33.37	33.38	0.340	0	–

Data	Method	$P \downarrow$ %	Mean $D \downarrow$ %	Max $D \downarrow$ %	Stress $\downarrow$	Events	Error $\downarrow$ %
Gaussian	Morton	25.76	33.37	33.38	0.242	0	–
Gaussian	**RG-MTM-P (ours)**	<u>5.43</u>	**0.00**	**0.00**	0.343	0	–
Gaussian	**RG-MTM-R (ours)**	1.38	3.35	9.98	0.238	0	–
Gaussian	Packed sort	**0.00**	8.09	12.74	**0.194**	0	–
Gaussian	Fixed X (control)	25.76	**0.00**	**0.00**	0.308	0	–
Gaussian	Exact projection	0.00	–	–	0.216	0	–

Table S7: Retained exact-frontier checks. Half a pixel defines tightness. Selected-order optima exclude secondary-layout slack. These are solver/frontier validation diagnostics, not rankings between datasets.

Data	Max leaves	Tight breaks	Max $F - \Phi \downarrow$ %	RG-MTM-R (ours) on $F \uparrow$	Max excess $\downarrow$ %
Storms	8	174/290	21.86	118/118	0.00
Wildfires	11	72/207	11.03	28/30	0.55
OLR	8	175/204	16.31	60/60	0.00
PM2.5	5	29/48	9.29	30/30	0.00
Ring	7	38/133	5.84	39/40	0.14
Gaussian	4	53/147	2.78	64/64	0.00

Table S8: Recomputed scalar filling checks. Bold scalar costs identify the smaller of LCA and optimal filling for the same dataset and setting (ties included). The residual includes strict-extremum clearance and is normalized as recorded.

Data	κ/range	LCA max $\downarrow$ %	Optimal max $\downarrow$ %	Formula residual $\downarrow$
Storms	0.0	**0.00**	**0.00**	0
Storms	0.02	1.72	**1.15**	1.1e-05
Storms	0.2	29.56	**26.07**	1.1e-05
Storms	∞	64.50	**58.66**	1.1e-05
Wildfires	0.0	**0.00**	**0.00**	0
Wildfires	0.02	1.90	**1.66**	2.8e-07
Wildfires	0.2	19.65	**19.56**	3.4e-07
Wildfires	∞	52.92	**52.58**	3.4e-07
OLR	0.0	**0.00**	**0.00**	0
OLR	0.02	1.85	**1.79**	1.3e-06
OLR	0.2	33.59	**33.56**	1.5e-06
OLR	∞	33.59	**33.56**	1.5e-06
PM2.5	0.0	**0.00**	**0.00**	0
PM2.5	0.02	0.00	**0.00**	0
PM2.5	0.2	10.37	**9.48**	6.1e-07
PM2.5	∞	25.80	**17.27**	6.1e-07
Ring	0.0	**0.00**	**0.00**	0
Ring	0.02	4.32	**2.16**	0
Ring	0.2	24.69	**12.35**	0
Ring	∞	24.69	**12.35**	0
Gaussian	0.0	**0.00**	**0.00**	0
Gaussian	0.02	**0.00**	**0.00**	0
Gaussian	0.2	19.97	**9.98**	1.9e-17
Gaussian	∞	24.84	**12.42**	1.9e-17

Table S9: Retained exploratory PM2.5 seasonal audit: motion error percentages. January was selected for display after this comparison. Bold rates are minima among the three shown methods within each month, with ties; event counts are small.

Month	Frames	Conflicts	Events	ST-MTM ↓	**RG-MTM-P (ours)** ↓	**RG-MTM-R (ours)** ↓
Jan	30	5	7	42.9	42.9	**28.6**
Apr	30	3	1	**0.0**	**0.0**	**0.0**
Jul	30	4	8	12.5	**0.0**	12.5
Oct	30	0	3	100.0	**0.0**	**0.0**

Table S10: Retained direction sensitivity: conflict shares at 2% across eight fixed directions.

Data	Minimum conflict %	Maximum conflict %
Storms	11.0	34.7
Wildfires	50.0	76.7
OLR	5.0	50.0
PM2.5	0.0	30.0

Table S11: Complete spatial and temporal diagnostics for the six-dataset suite.

Data	Method	Flips↓	Jitter↓	Stress↓	NN↑
Storms	TMTM	0.092	0.046	0.317	0.746
Storms	ST-MTM	0.050	**0.027**	**0.194**	**0.877**
Storms	Hilbert	0.078	0.059	0.326	0.726
Storms	Morton	**0.014**	0.046	0.352	0.679
Storms	Packed sort	0.078	0.086	0.299	0.672
Storms	**RG-MTM-P (ours)**	0.110	0.101	0.327	0.731
Storms	**RG-MTM-R,** 20% **(ours)**	0.073	0.089	0.308	0.700
Storms	**RG-MTM-R,** ∞ **(ours)**	0.083	0.086	0.296	0.682
Storms	Exact projection	0.078	0.086	0.310	0.660
Wildfires	TMTM	0.334	0.102	0.458	0.639
Wildfires	ST-MTM	0.076	0.053	0.256	**0.753**
Wildfires	Hilbert	0.016	0.020	0.479	0.559
Wildfires	Morton	0.010	**0.015**	0.308	0.530
Wildfires	Packed sort	**0.005**	0.018	0.219	0.594
Wildfires	**RG-MTM-P (ours)**	0.094	0.054	0.261	0.658
Wildfires	**RG-MTM-R,** 20% **(ours)**	0.026	0.022	0.221	0.630
Wildfires	**RG-MTM-R,** ∞ **(ours)**	0.010	0.019	**0.219**	0.600
Wildfires	Exact projection	0.005	0.017	0.227	0.589
OLR	TMTM	0.181	0.089	0.379	0.708
OLR	ST-MTM	0.007	**0.016**	0.097	0.913
OLR	Hilbert	0.051	0.078	0.358	0.691
OLR	Morton	0.130	0.085	0.528	0.508
OLR	Packed sort	**0.000**	0.058	**0.074**	**0.915**
OLR	**RG-MTM-P (ours)**	**0.000**	0.061	0.084	0.912
OLR	**RG-MTM-R,** 20% **(ours)**	**0.000**	0.058	**0.074**	**0.915**
OLR	**RG-MTM-R,** ∞ **(ours)**	**0.000**	0.058	**0.074**	**0.915**
OLR	Exact projection	0.000	0.061	0.081	0.918
PM2.5	TMTM	0.048	0.081	0.241	0.771
PM2.5	ST-MTM	**0.000**	**0.027**	**0.137**	**0.903**
PM2.5	Hilbert	0.190	0.191	0.347	0.515

Data	Method	Flips↓	Jitter↓	Stress↓	NN↑
PM2.5	Morton	0.048	0.194	0.409	0.469
PM2.5	Packed sort	0.095	0.189	0.436	0.547
PM2.5	**RG-MTM-P (ours)**	**0.000**	0.201	0.508	0.588
PM2.5	**RG-MTM-R,** 20% **(ours)**	0.143	0.198	0.443	0.601
PM2.5	**RG-MTM-R,** ∞ **(ours)**	0.095	0.190	0.433	0.581
PM2.5	Exact projection	0.095	0.184	0.464	0.568
Ring	TMTM	0.118	0.034	0.451	0.429
Ring	ST-MTM	0.030	0.030	**0.316**	**0.764**
Ring	Hilbert	**0.018**	**0.021**	0.336	0.677
Ring	Morton	**0.018**	0.023	0.374	0.657
Ring	Packed sort	0.022	0.031	0.374	0.539
Ring	**RG-MTM-P (ours)**	0.114	0.054	0.402	0.494
Ring	**RG-MTM-R,** 20% **(ours)**	0.059	0.037	0.372	0.553
Ring	**RG-MTM-R,** ∞ **(ours)**	0.059	0.037	0.372	0.553
Ring	Exact projection	0.022	0.029	0.389	0.560
Gaussian	TMTM	0.004	0.003	0.584	0.445
Gaussian	ST-MTM	**0.000**	0.002	0.291	0.605
Gaussian	Hilbert	**0.000**	**0.001**	0.340	0.605
Gaussian	Morton	0.004	0.003	0.242	0.801
Gaussian	Packed sort	0.004	0.003	**0.194**	**0.926**
Gaussian	**RG-MTM-P (ours)**	**0.000**	0.003	0.343	0.605
Gaussian	**RG-MTM-R,** 20% **(ours)**	0.004	0.005	0.238	0.790
Gaussian	**RG-MTM-R,** ∞ **(ours)**	0.004	0.004	0.195	0.900
Gaussian	Exact projection	0.004	0.003	0.216	0.926

Flips and jitter describe stability, not agreement with physical motion. Stress and NN use original extremum distances on frames with at least three extrema. Bold entries mark per-dataset numerical optima among displayed rendered methods, including ties; exact projection is a diagnostic control excluded from ranking. The main text discusses selected comparisons from this complete control population.

S3.2 Standard-metric re-evaluation

The primary NROE and NMLE measures answer the reference-order and labelled-merge questions. To test their relationship to established criteria, we separately reconstructed the same six datasets and four fixed main configurations and saved their actual raster anchors. No parameter search or change to the scientific algorithms was performed. The resulting standard metrics are additional measurements, rather than renamed historical *S*/NN/*J* values.

Geometry and stability. SNS follows the scale-normalized squared residual used by ST-MTM [2, 11], using pairwise support-centroid distances. We average valid frames with at least two features and nonzero source-distance norm; the saved record also reports the nontrivial $n \geq 3$ subset. TW uses the standard rank penalty [13], with $k = 1$ shared by all methods and datasets and the validity condition $k < n/2$. Larger $k = 3, 5$ settings are retained only on eligible frames; for example, Storms has just two valid $k = 3$ frames. A two-feature frame can fit its single distance exactly after scaling but cannot supply a valid $k = 1$ TW score.

TD sums matched-anchor absolute displacements. To compare display coordinates, each method's full-sequence canvas is mapped once to $[0, 1]$ using its actual raster extent; this is not per-frame normalization or occupied-range rescaling. TD is reported in canvas-width units and must be compared within a dataset. Stable leaf-row order resolves distance ties; the saved sensitivity uses the same tie-free frame subset for all methods.

Table S12: Standard geometry and stability re-evaluation on the unchanged main configurations.

Data	Method	SNS↓	TW_1 ↑	TD↓	N_{SNS}	N_{TW}
Storms	TMTM	0.0799	0.8243	10.1108	115	88
Storms	ST-MTM	0.0297	0.9653	7.1607	115	88

Data	Method	SNS↓	TW_1 ↑	TD↓	N_{SNS}	N_{TW}
Storms	RG-MTM-P	0.1186	0.7771	27.3609	115	88
Storms	RG-MTM-R	0.1097	0.7554	23.8891	115	88
Wildfires	TMTM	0.2210	0.8170	11.2034	30	30
Wildfires	ST-MTM	0.0786	0.9195	7.9585	30	30
Wildfires	RG-MTM-P	0.0831	0.8793	8.0342	30	30
Wildfires	RG-MTM-R	0.0579	0.8725	3.2487	30	30
OLR	TMTM	0.1419	0.8135	8.7479	60	52
OLR	ST-MTM	0.0062	0.9751	2.3304	60	52
OLR	RG-MTM-P	0.0121	0.9587	8.9011	60	52
OLR	RG-MTM-R	0.0093	0.9634	8.5023	60	52
PM2.5	TMTM	0.0386	0.8021	2.6858	25	12
PM2.5	ST-MTM	0.0148	0.9896	1.0620	25	12
PM2.5	RG-MTM-P	0.1443	0.6194	6.2830	25	12
PM2.5	RG-MTM-R	0.1137	0.5986	6.1880	25	12
Ring	TMTM	0.1706	0.7067	1.3436	32	27
Ring	ST-MTM	0.0803	0.9172	2.3641	32	27
Ring	RG-MTM-P	0.1637	0.7087	3.5977	32	27
Ring	RG-MTM-R	0.1423	0.7149	2.3512	32	27
Gaussian	TMTM	0.3172	0.5247	0.1260	64	64
Gaussian	ST-MTM	0.0845	0.7533	0.2287	64	64
Gaussian	RG-MTM-P	0.1222	0.7533	0.3705	64	64
Gaussian	RG-MTM-R	0.0638	0.8639	0.5396	64	64

SNS and TW use support centroids. TD is summed in full-canvas-width units, not occupied-range-normalized mean displacement. N columns count valid frames; TW uses $k = 1$. All values are descriptive.

Relative to ST-MTM, RG-MTM-R has lower SNS on Wildfires (0.0579 versus 0.0786) and Gaussian (0.0638 versus 0.0845), higher TW only on Gaussian, and lower TD on Wildfires and Ring. The Ring TD difference is approximately 0.55%. Storms, OLR and PM2.5 are worse on all three measures. RG-MTM-P has higher SNS and TD on every sequence. These results preclude a claim of universal geometry/stability improvement.

Standard rank correlations. Kendall τ_b and Spearman ρ compare the displayed anchors with the existing fixed-direction extremum references. A single optional reflection is fixed from the reference-minimum/maximum anchors in the first informative frame common to all methods (Ring: frame 8; others: frame 0); no per-frame reflection or whole-sequence score maximization is used. Main correlations average common valid $n \geq 3$ frames; raw-orientation and $n \geq 2$ summaries are also saved. The reference itself is fitted offline from the sequence, so these measure construction under a specified reference, not held-out prediction. High correlation does not imply low absolute displacement.

Motion classification. Using the same two-step and 2% thresholds as the main proxy, all tracked-pair windows receive approach, unchanged or separation labels. Balanced accuracy averages recalls of the true classes; macro-F1 averages classwise F1 with the three labels fixed. Unlike the clear-event ME subset, this also penalizes spurious changes in unchanged source pairs. These are computational labels, not participant responses. PM2.5 supplies only ten windows (seven clear events), and Gaussian truth has only the unchanged class; we do not use that single-class case to assess motion classification.

Table S13: Standard order correlations and three-class geometric motion scores.

Data	Method	τ_b ↑	ρ ↑	BA (%)↑	F1 (%)↑	Windows
Storms	TMTM	-0.0011	-0.0181	48.2	47.3	127
Storms	ST-MTM	-0.0072	0.0033	55.8	54.6	127
Storms	RG-MTM-P	0.7653	0.8268	57.5	56.2	127
Storms	RG-MTM-R	0.8924	0.9282	63.1	62.9	127
Wildfires	TMTM	0.3023	0.3409	50.9	45.8	238
Wildfires	ST-MTM	0.2039	0.2660	53.0	46.6	238
Wildfires	RG-MTM-P	0.8433	0.9132	55.7	47.9	238

Data	Method	$\tau_b \uparrow$	$\rho \uparrow$	BA (%)↑	F1 (%)↑	Windows
Wildfires	RG-MTM-R	0.9793	0.9926	68.3	66.3	238
OLR	TMTM	-0.1351	-0.1808	41.7	41.7	63
OLR	ST-MTM	0.0101	0.0078	71.4	68.5	63
OLR	RG-MTM-P	0.9683	0.9812	91.7	89.2	63
OLR	RG-MTM-R	1.0000	1.0000	96.4	93.4	63
PM2.5	TMTM	0.5611	0.6333	19.4	19.0	10
PM2.5	ST-MTM	0.4500	0.5083	38.9	32.4	10
PM2.5	RG-MTM-P	0.6611	0.7250	61.1	62.4	10
PM2.5	RG-MTM-R	0.9111	0.9250	69.4	71.1	10
Ring	TMTM	-0.1855	-0.2561	32.9	31.9	209
Ring	ST-MTM	0.2892	0.3458	52.1	49.9	209
Ring	RG-MTM-P	0.6780	0.7778	52.2	46.2	209
Ring	RG-MTM-R	0.9111	0.9317	70.4	63.5	209
Gaussian	TMTM	0.4740	0.5828	–	–	237
Gaussian	ST-MTM	0.5573	0.6828	–	–	237
Gaussian	RG-MTM-P	0.5573	0.6828	–	–	237
Gaussian	RG-MTM-R	0.7292	0.7969	–	–	237

Correlations use the common $n \geq 3$ frames and one fixed orientation calibration; BA and macro-F1 use all two-step tracked-pair windows, including unchanged truth. Gaussian has only unchanged labels and is not used to assess motion classification. PM2.5 has only ten windows. These are computational proxies, not participant responses.

RG-MTM-R has higher reference-order correlations on all six sequences. It also has higher three-class balanced accuracy and macro-F1 on the five evaluable sequences than either baseline. These descriptive differences support the declared reference and motion tasks, not a combined quality ranking or a significance claim. Adjacent windows overlap. The actual raster evaluation changes one Ring RG-MTM-R decision relative to the historical continuous-anchor proxy (15 rather than 16 errors among 124 clear events); other main clear-event counts and errors agree.

Verification and evidence. TW agrees with scikit-learn 1.7.2 in 285 random comparisons to machine precision. Ninety SNS checks against independent numerical scale minimization, scale and reflection invariance, identity matching with births and deaths, and static-layout TD checks pass. The geometry and stability summaries are reproduced from saved landmark arrays. Direct pair counting and confusion matrices reproduce the new rank and classification summaries. Input hashes and original scientific sources are unchanged. The separate result folder `results/public_metrics_20261016/` contains source hashes, landmark arrays, protocols and metric summaries; historical result files retain their original keys and values.

S3.3 Sensitivity and additional evidence

Direction, extraction, tracking, persistence, and layout choices affect the tested quantities. The grouped sensitivity records contain eight fixed-direction checks and 1%, 2%, and 5% hierarchy-cost triggers; three change thresholds and four motion windows; ST-MTM parameter variants; extraction-scale and crop variants; and the four-month PM2.5 audit. They are exploratory analyses and use no multiplicity correction. Historical second-period Storms entries in source aggregates are excluded from the main six-sequence snapshot.

Persistence and feature population. In the retained Storms study, a 1% scalar-range cutoff removes 27.9% of leaves and leaves 23.7% of frames conflicting; at 2% these become 34.1% and 18.6%; at 5%, 46.2% and 10.2%. This control changes the leaf set, whereas RG-MTM relaxation retains extrema. Extraction at 150 km is evaluated through certified lower bounds only. The weak background in Wildfires has not been varied.

Scalability. The retained binary diagnosis benchmark takes about 3.6 seconds for 4096 leaves on 16384 pixels. The degree-controlled record varies root degree while fixing widths, references, and pixel count. Its exponential subset recurrence is distinct from full-layout order enumeration. These timings are properties of the retained benchmark environment, not measured construction times for large scalar fields.

Dendrogram transfer. A retained experiment orders 1024 active fire cells by a dendrogram of their temporal signals. Its one-pixel-row model yields a positional certificate of 67.3% of display height; optimal leaf ordering reaches 88.2% maximum displacement. Geographic order has 20.6% maximum error, reflecting packing rather than hierarchy. This transfers the positional model only; no scalar-barrier or participant-performance result follows. Source: `dendrogram_demo.json`.

Dendrogram model and numerical precision. The November–December 2019 cell observations are summed into 30 two-day bins and transformed by $\log(1+\mathrm{FRP})$. Cell locations use the mean-latitude longitude scale $111.32\cos(\phi_0)$ and latitude scale 110.57 km per degree, then project onto the leading geographic principal component, oriented northward. References are scaled to $[0.5, 1023.5]$. Centered, unit-norm time-series vectors supply Euclidean distances for average linkage and SciPy OLO. Every leaf has width 1, with zero gap, eccentricity allowance, and extra budget; the canvas has 1024 rows. Thus every admissible layout is fully packed and its anchors are exactly row centers. Sorted reference assignment attains the unrestricted minimax cost 210.4424984 rows (20.5510252%).

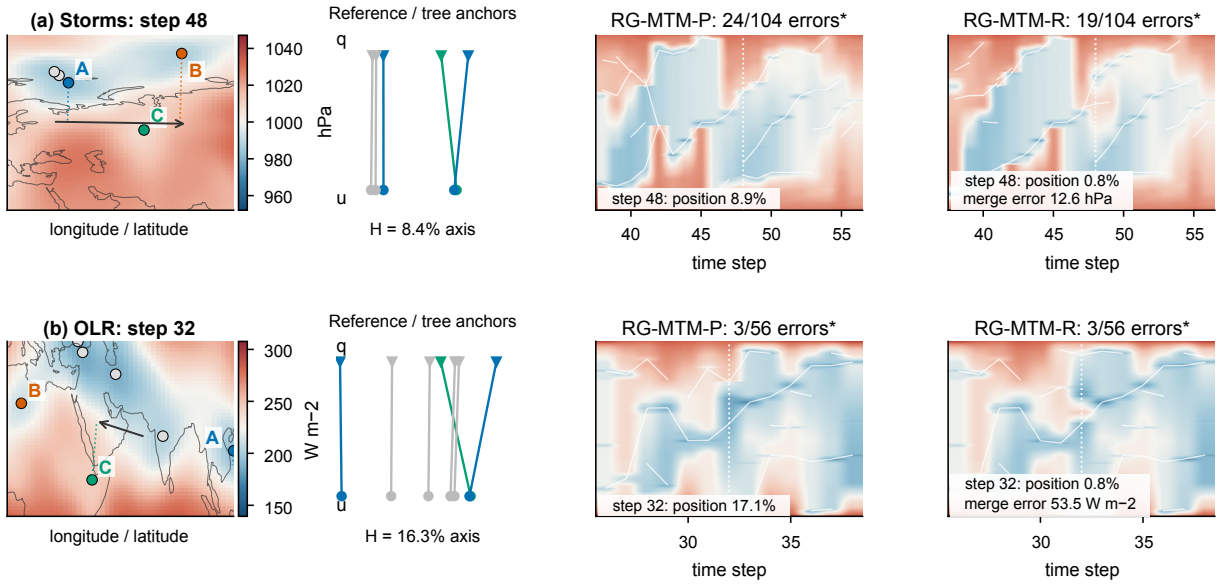
The saved display-resolution DP returns a feasible upper endpoint 689.0042725 rows for the hierarchy optimum with bisection tolerance 0.25 row. Consequently, $688.7542725 < \tau^* \leq 689.0042725$ rows, or $67.2612\% < \tau^*/1024 \leq 67.2856\%$. The main-paper value of approximately 67.29% and the dashed guide use that saved endpoint; the corresponding hierarchy cost is approximately 46.73 percentage points, with a bracket $(46.7101, 46.7345]$. No half-pixel allowance is required for this fully packed equal-row model. OLO's observed maximum is 88.2287773%, independently recorded from its row assignment. These quantities diagnose geographic position rather than the temporal-similarity objective optimized by OLO. The plot and full-precision result are retained as `figures/Supplement_Dendrogram_Transfer.pdf` and `evidence/dendrogram_transfer/dendrogram_demo.json`; the associated generality record includes other hierarchies and the separate timing benchmark.

Failure conditions. Infeasible total packing requires changing geometry before certification. Strict extrema require sufficiently separated raster anchors; the renderer rejects collapsed gaps. A non-unique principal motion direction requires an external reference. A small hierarchy cost does not establish good two-dimensional distance preservation, and improved order alignment does not necessarily improve motion-proxy error, as shown by OLR. Cases with zero clear events remain undefined.

S4 Additional Visual Evidence

The following figures complement the main tables with the retained primary anchor-based motion and extremum-based geometry diagnostics. Their displayed ME percentages are 100 times the decimal rates used in the main table. Standard centroid-based SNS, TW, and canvas-normalized TD remain in Supplement S3.

S4.1 Local Witnesses and the Absolute-Reference Control



* Errors use the complete sequence, not just the displayed window. Scalar colors are shared within each row.

Figure S1: Local Storms and OLR witnesses retained from the previous integrated revision. Source fields, reference-to-anchor links, and P/R windows explain the individual hierarchy conflicts. Local labels report maximum anchor error and scalar cost; map titles give complete-sequence motion-proxy counts. Storms is the frame-48 example in the main introduction; OLR is the retained frame-32 example.

The independent absolute-reference control is shown in main-paper Fig. 6. Section S2.8 gives its protocol, calibration, and measurements; Fig. S9 retains the full visual comparison.

S4.2 Motion Errors and Scalar Costs

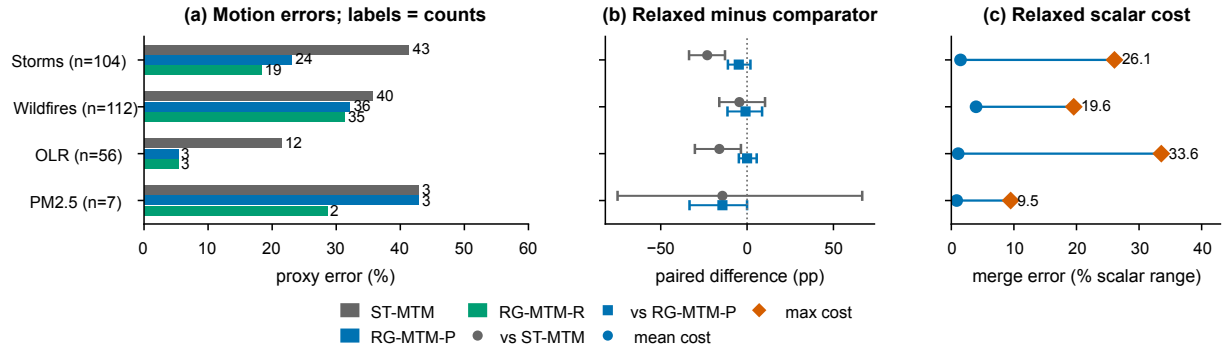


Figure S2: Four real sequences: primary motion-error counts and rates, paired relaxed-minus-comparator differences with retained temporal-block 95% intervals, and relaxed mean/maximum scalar costs. The reference protocol fixes a two-step window and 2% thresholds; PM2.5 has seven clear events. Scalar costs in this drawing use the saved fixed-order optimum; measured raster values agree to the numerical tolerance reported in the main text.

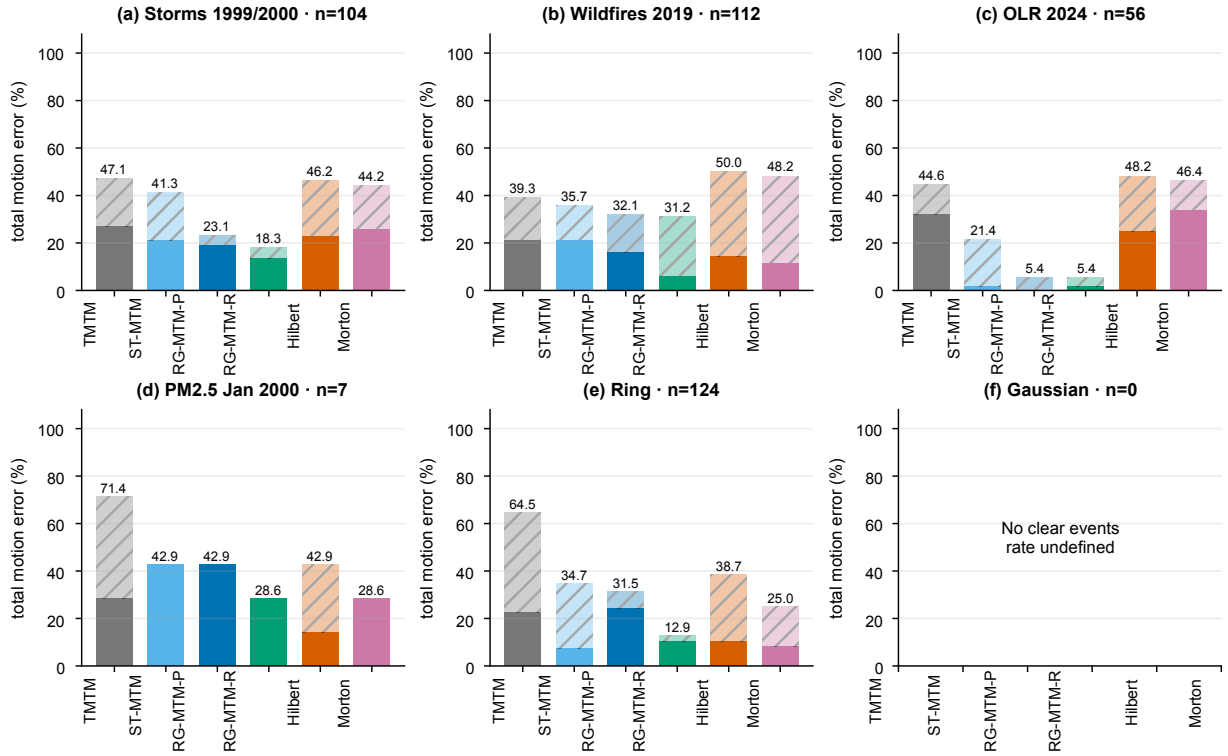


Figure S3: Primary motion errors decomposed into reversals and misses across six sequences and the native curve controls. Solid portions show reversals and hatched portions show misses. Denominators are the shared clear two-dimensional events. Gaussian has no clear events at this setting and retains an undefined rate.

S4.3 Geometric Neighbourhoods

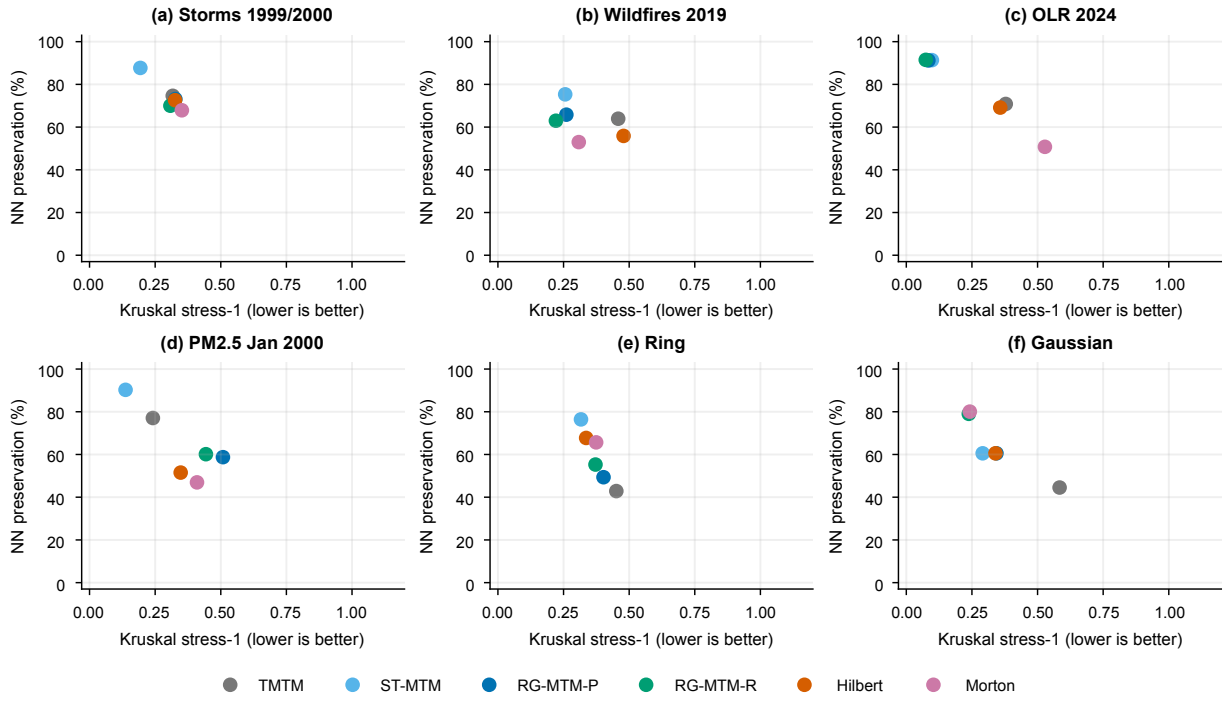


Figure S4: Retained extremum-based stress-1 and nearest-neighbour identity preservation on frames with at least three extrema. Each method keeps its own anchor geometry. These metrics use different definitions from SNS and TW, whose complete values and eligible-frame counts are reported in Supplement S3.

S4.4 Window Sensitivity

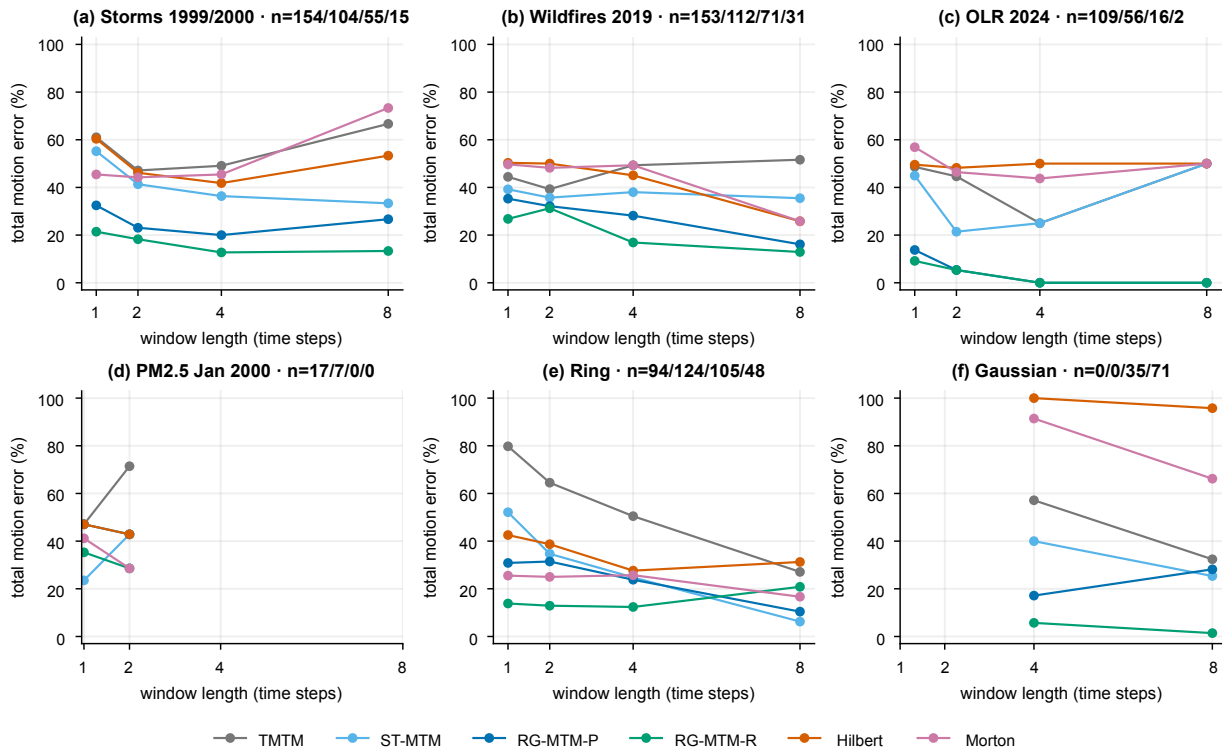


Figure S5: Motion error for windows of 1, 2, 4, and 8 steps at the same 2% thresholds. Each window has its own event set, with counts shown in that order above each panel. Sampling intervals differ by dataset. Undefined rates are omitted, including Gaussian at one and two steps.

S4.5 Native Sample Traversals and Scalar Cost

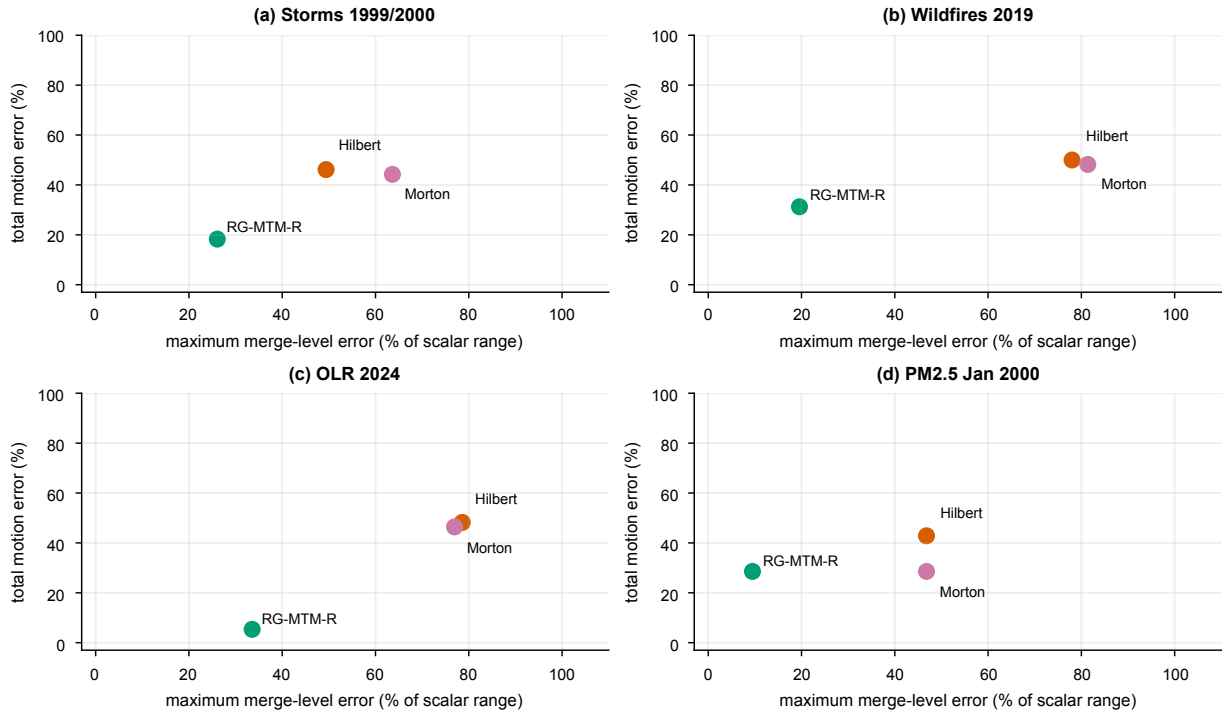


Figure S6: Motion error versus maximum merge-level distortion for RG-MTM-R and native Hilbert/Morton traversals. Each point is one fixed operating setting; native curves retain original sample values while RG-MTM-R uses optimal refilling. The comparison includes both ordering and rendering policy. Horizontal values are sequence maxima of the saved scalar-cost summaries.

S5 Reproducibility and Evidence Roles

The code repository contains experiment orchestration, method implementations, tests, and grouped numerical records; the local source package supplies this manuscript and supplement. The integrated source package contains the manuscript, supplement, selected existing figures, numerical evidence, and export documentation. Raw data are excluded and require the local prepared data or the acquisition steps in `data/README.md`. The independent runner invokes existing scientific entry points and records commands, runtime, exit status, source hashes, and result hashes. It does not change their algorithms or reported thresholds.

Main evaluation. `experiments/publication2027/run.py` defaults to the six active sequences and the five rerun numerical stages. Explicit selection of all ten available stages also recomputes replication, exact frontiers, direction robustness, persistence controls, and witnesses. Retained sensitivity records are not labelled new runs. Per-stage logs and completion manifests reside under `results/publication2027/runs/`.

Evidence packaging. `experiments/publication2027/build.py` checks source hashes for positional and native-merge evidence, consistent frame counts, unique motion rows, and hierarchy lower bounds. It exports unrounded comparisons, a claim ledger, generated LaTeX tables, and source/snapshot hashes. Mixed aggregate files are filtered to the six active sequences in the main-evidence snapshot. Sensitivity, formal validation, protocols, and dendrogram transfer have separate folders. The original records remain available for historical traceability.

Numerical checks. The existing test suite includes independent LP comparisons, grid lower-bound checks, projected-motion margins, native sample and barrier semantics, preprocessing contracts, and no-event handling. The retained implementation-validation run passed 25 tests; the separate standard-metric re-evaluation adds metric and reconstruction checks without method changes. The validation checks cover numerical optimization, rendering semantics, and metric reconstruction.

Publication configuration. The main source uses the unmodified IEEE VGTC conference class in review mode. The main manuscript retains the supplied five-stage pipeline and integrates feature-linked Storms, Wildfires, and Tangaroa figures with the certificate and scalar-filling analysis. This supplement provides full derivations, pseudocode, protocols, complete geometric comparisons, and the volumetric evidence ledger. The additional mirror-motion control, static inputs, and volumetric sequences are reported separately from the six-sequence planar suite. Submission ID 0 is to be replaced with the PCS identifier; Codex assistance is disclosed in the acknowledgments.

S6 Original-Grid Tangaroa Protocol and Complete Evidence

S6.1 Input processing and extracted features

The formal volumetric entry point is `experiments/volume3d/run_paper.py`. The input contains all 201 official Tangaroa velocity fields, indices 0–200, time increment 0.01, on the original XYZ grid $300 \times 180 \times 120$. Physical bounds are $[-0.35, 0.65] \times [-0.3, 0.3] \times [-0.5, -0.3]$. Velocity magnitude uses float64 arithmetic followed by float32 storage. Values below 10^{-6} are replaced by 1; values are clipped to $[0, 2]$. There is no spatial downsampling, Gaussian smoothing, per-frame normalization, or leaf-count-based frame selection.

TTK 0.9.9 [12] traditional topological simplification modifies the scalar field at absolute persistence threshold 0.2, using regular-grid implicit triangulation, nonperiodic boundaries, no added scalar perturbation, and the returned symbolic offsets. The simplified field supplies the augmented join tree. This one persistence setting is fixed throughout the formal comparison. The actual trees contain 36–186 nodes and 18–93 leaves. TMTM reports 50–186 nodes for its 10% row; the author-final scalar export and binary environment are unavailable, so exact derived-tree identity is unresolved. The public input grid and frame count agree, as do recorded magnitude fingerprints, including the initial raw maximum 3.0590057373046875.

Each leaf support contains its extremum vertex and incident leaf-arc regular samples. Its centroid and extremum position are computed in physical three-dimensional coordinates. Support volume equals sample count times the fixed physical sample measure. Positive original-voxel support intersections define a one-to-one Hungarian match. There are 6925 leaf-support instances, of which 2459 touch the boundary. The reference direction $(0.1019540600, -0.9945466284, -0.0219630047)$ uses 6214 matched extremum displacements and captures 0.5768552452 of their squared motion. The eight projected domain corners give origin -0.3274590081 and extent $L = 0.7030746380$.

S6.2 Shared parameters and method-specific construction

All rendered methods share the same TTK-simplified inputs and source merge targets. RG parameters are $c|\Omega| = L/2$, $g = L/240$, $\rho = 0.5$, and allowance $\beta = L/120$. The hierarchy trigger is $H > 0.02L$; eligibility fractions are 0.02, 0.2, and 1 of the declared scalar range 2. Volumetric R flattens every eligible non-root branching node and disables the optional two-dimensional restoration/pruning stage.

For continuous primary certificates, low-arity nodes use earliest-finish Pareto DP with bisection. Higher-arity cases use workload bounds or a 2-second HiGHS MILP, retaining feasible primal and dual bounds. With tree bounds $[l_T, u_T]$ and free-order bounds $[l_f, u_f]$, the hierarchy cost lies within $[\max(0, l_T - u_f), u_T - l_f]$. The gate activates when its lower bound exceeds $0.02L$, stays inactive when its upper bound does not, and preserves the hierarchy in unresolved cases. The formal run has 201 active, zero inactive, and zero unresolved original-tree gates.

Each layout uses the primary upper bound plus β. Candidate orders include the certificate witness, reference-preferred recursive order, previous-position-preferred recursive order, and TMTM order when legal and within budget. Duplicate candidates are removed; at most four are configured and at most three occur in the saved run. The convex QP records the constraint slack and the first-order gap from an independent linear oracle. This solves the secondary objective on the evaluated candidate set. Frames are processed sequentially.

TMTM starts at frame 100 and propagates top-down normal/reversed child decisions forward and backward using subtree overlaps. An m-way saddle requires $m-1$ separators: its source sample and $m-2$ additional copies at the same scalar value. Exactly 27 extra separators occur across the sequence. The source volume remains unchanged; saved sample IDs independently verify one occurrence of every original sample plus precisely those copies. ST-MTM layout was not run in this formal original-grid comparison; its scalar/path filler is reused by RG. Separate synthetic three-dimensional extensions are retained outside this real-data table.

S6.3 Metric aggregation and complete parameter comparison

NROE is the temporal mean of framewise width-free order error. Actual RG MAE averages rendered-anchor error within each frame and then over the 201 frames; this differs from the pooled continuous feature-frame displacement used for the planar suite. NMLE measures maximum pairwise source-LCA versus actual-profile merge discrepancy in each frame, divides by the declared scalar range 2, and reports temporal mean and maximum.

Motion compares labelled pairs shared by frames separated by lag 1, 2, or 4, with thresholds 1%, 2%, or 5%. Spatial truth uses physical three-dimensional distance and domain diagonal; projected truth uses reference distance

and L. Display decisions use the same fraction of each method's sequence-wide occupied anchor range. Default lag 2 and 2% gives 6755 spatial clear events, including 1422 fully interior events, and 9631 projected clear events. These are different event sets. Table S14 gives the default decomposition.

Table S14: Complete default Tangaroa measurements. Errors are percentages. Motion entries are reversal + miss counts; denominators are 6755 in 3D and 9631 for projected distance.

Method	NROE	MAE	NMLE mean	NMLE max	3D	Projected
TMTM	20.09230	–	0	0	185+6400	240+9168
P	9.60801	5.12470	0	0	1613+2084	2072+2973
R2	8.56031	4.31072	3.51512	11.53659	1467+1811	1601+2322
R20	0.018945	1.06487	14.44212	31.02051	826+1234	22+218
R100	0.018945	1.06487	14.44212	31.02051	826+1234	22+218
Exact projection	0	0	–	–	763+1297	0+0

P and TMTM have zero measured source-leaf merge error in all 201 frames; R2 has three zero-error frames and R20/R100 have none at tolerance 10^{-6}. The primary P certificate has maximum bracket width $1.98358 \times 10^{-10}L$. R2 has 48 brackets not closed to tolerance and maximum width $0.0956105L$; R20/R100 close to tolerance in this sequence. The maximum selected-QP first-order gap, normalized by L^2, is 2.03871×10^{-7}; over all evaluated candidates it is approximately 2.06326×10^{-7}. Maximum anchor-rounding and interval-width errors are $3.81427 \times 10^{-6}L$ and $7.61058 \times 10^{-6}L$.

S6.4 Independent verification and display provenance

The retained full numerical verification independently re-read 201 original velocity volumes, checked ZIP CRC32 and SHA256, reconstructed all 1,302,480,000 preprocessed scalar samples, and obtained zero maximum difference. It verified augmented sample ownership, arc monotonicity, physical extrema and centroids, support measures, direct parent-chain LCA targets, every full saved map's measured barriers, layout budgets, interval constraints, and TMTM sample-ID multiplicities. A separate rounded-down grid check provided continuous-certificate lower bounds at eleven uniformly spaced frames. These results are stored in `results/volume3d/tangaroa-paper-p10-full201/verification.json`.

`metrics.json` stores all motion settings; `frame_metrics.json` stores complete per-frame measurements, layouts, bounds, and array hashes; `protocol.json`, `manifest.json`, `features.json`, `reference.json`, and `certificates.json` bind the inputs, source code, and numerical results. Full source volumes, simplified scalars, and 131072-row RG maps remain in local prepared-data storage. The lightweight `verify_saved.py` checks distributed evidence bindings, whereas `verify_paper.py` performs full numerical verification with the local arrays.

Main-paper Figure 10 and the complete comparison in S10 reuse frozen 4096-row display samples for all 201 frames, with a local window at 135–145 and source-volume views at 139–141. The source views show pre-TTK near-zero-replaced and clipped magnitudes; simplified-input renderings and earlier context views at 0, 100, and 200 remain separately archived. The main views share the original purple–white–orange transfer function and one full-domain orthographic camera; S8 records the camera and projected-marker provenance. These display choices do not change the trees, layouts, or metrics, which use the full arrays. R100 duplicates R20 in this formal comparison, while input persistence remains fixed at 10%.

S7 Event Correspondence and Baseline Audit

S7.1 Frozen case figures and selection

The event-linked drawings use the existing arrays in `results/real_case_studies/evidence/`: retained scalar profiles, extremum coordinates, overlap matches, and original-observation or original-grid volume views. The three-page `rgmtm_large_figures.pdf` and its individual vector pages are preserved in `figures/source/real_case_studies/`. The preceding P/R-only panels remain as traceable sources. The main paper shows source-linked P/R maps; S10 retains saved TMTM/ST-MTM planar profiles and saved TMTM volumetric profiles, using their native ordinates alongside the RG reference axis. Complete-frame maps retain all time steps; local enlargements state their own coordinate ranges. Source markers and temporal anchors use recorded transformations (S8). The plotting export calls no extraction, layout solver, metric evaluation, or volume renderer.

Storms frame 48 is the previously retained interior hierarchy witness. W1 selects the largest hierarchy cost, with earliest-frame tie-breaking, among above-trigger Wildfires frames having a three-frame matched conflict triple and positive displacement reduction and scalar cost. These choices explain individual constructions; the complete-sequence tables provide the performance evidence. The archived Storms storm-time guides and Tangaroa context views follow the reference papers' selected temporal contexts independently of these witness-selection rules. Current main figures instead use the hourly Storms visualization and the Tangaroa frame-140 conflict window; their distinct populations and coordinates are documented in S8.

S7.2 Storms storm-time correspondence

TMTM Fig. 1 [8] supplies five December 1999 times; ST-MTM Fig. 6 [2] discusses the same month's storms. Convert an elapsed time from 17 November 1999 00 UTC into frame index by dividing by 12 hours. Table S15 separates each fractional guide position from the discrete snapshot. The circles locate nearby computed pressure minima, identified by the stored overlap-track IDs. Event labels specify temporal correspondence, not independently validated cyclone identity. E4 carries a time guide and a source snapshot without an assigned named-storm leaf.

Table S15: Reference-paper storm times and local Storms snapshots. Dates are in December 1999, UTC; fractional indices locate the dashed guides.

Guide	Reference-paper context	Day/time	Index	Snapshot	Track
E1	Anatol	03 / 18:00	33.500	34	37
E2	Scandinavia storm	17 / 21:00	61.750	62	66
E3	British Isles/Norway storm	24 / 23:00	75.917	76	87
E4	Lothar time window	26 / 10:00	78.833	79	–
E5	Martin time window	27 / 21:00	81.750	82	93

The reference papers use 744 hourly pressure-anomaly fields. The quantitative sequence audited here instead uses 118 half-day MSLP fields, a different region, and 250-km smoothing/minimum extraction. The main-paper teaser is a separate 744-hour anomaly visualization with its own extrema and track identifiers. Storms frame 79 contains two retained leaves and no independently identified Lothar leaf. These input differences determine what can be matched beyond a calendar time. Track 66 at frame 62 has normalized reference 0.637427, P anchor 0.600655, and R anchor 0.648027; the plotted markers use these saved coordinates.

S7.3 Wildfires witness, scalar values, and temporal links

W1 is frame 18, the two-day FRP aggregate starting 7 December 2019. The source snapshots show unsmoothed log-transformed observations; the circles are extrema of the processed split-tree field. Tracks A, B, C are IDs 3, 48, and 52, corresponding to local leaves 3192, 419, and 3285 at W1. Their preceding positive support-overlap IoUs are 0.306, 0.893, and 0.746, and all three continue to the next frame. The reference order is A, C, B; the original subtree joins A, B before the outside leaf C.

Table S16: Saved normalized reference and anchor coordinates of the W1 triple at frame 18. These use the complete shared reference extent.

Feature	Track	Reference	P anchor	R anchor	Extremum value
A	3	0.169078	0.193307	0.166133	2.408155
B	48	0.684591	0.537046	0.704579	0.765362
C	52	0.418239	0.549117	0.421862	0.193260

The original split-tree connection levels for *AB*, *AC*, and *BC* are 0.060800, 0.003617, and 0.003617. P retains them. The measured relaxed levels are -0.574262, 0.001144, and -0.574262, giving analytical fixed-order error 0.635062. The saved profile has measured worst-pair error 0.635063 after strict-extremum clearance, or 15.0944% of the processed sequence range (S8). Negative output levels are artificial connection values introduced by the fixed-extremum minimax correction; they are not negative FRP observations and are shown with an explicit blue under-range colour. The local scalar range and the theoretical fixed-order cost remain distinct from this measured output discrepancy. No physical fire-entity identification is inferred from the computational track IDs.

S7.4 Tangaroa temporal context and display provenance

The T1–T3 indices 25, 100, and 145 correspond to source times 0.25, 1.00, and 1.45 in the original 201-frame sequence. They follow TMTM Fig. 15 and its Tangaroa discussion: approximately frame 25 for reported group separation, frame 100 for the two-group volume illustration, and approximately frame 145 for a departing group's disappearance. TMTM Fig. 14 instead concerns Cylinder; its phase labels are not transferred to Tangaroa. ST-MTM provides no corresponding real three-dimensional experiment.

These are temporal context links, not verified cross-method feature-group identities. The RG axis is a fixed directional projection and differs from the original TMTM linearization coordinate. Source-volume snapshots at 0, 25, 100, 145, and 200 reuse `tangaroa_event_volumes.npz`; the views at 25 and 145 were added in the preceding case-study task, and all five were already cached before manuscript integration. They show pre-TTK near-zero-replaced and clipped magnitudes; the time maps retain the fixed-10%-persistence join-tree inputs specified in S6. These archived context views are distinct from the current main-paper views at frames 139–141, whose camera and marker provenance are documented in S8.

S7.5 Baseline algorithm checks on 148 real-data frames

The existing audit covers 118 Storms frames and 30 Wildfires frames. TMTM is checked against the official repository at `https://github.com/Wiebke/TemporalMergeTreeMaps`. The fixed revision is recorded separately:

```
2c75a10ed2cd55177a25ff751e0c0a8261200717
```

A harness compiles the author's `LandscapeInfo`, `objectiveForSeveralArcs`, `decideGreedy`, and `decideGreedyTree` core, supplying the same extracted real trees and spatial overlap counts. Every one of 486 branch decisions and 1118 interval/anchor records agrees. All processed samples appear once, subtree leaves remain contiguous, and measured pairwise merge error is zero in all 148 frames. This verifies the tested binary core, separately from a complete author Inviwo/TTK environment.

ST-MTM checks reconstruct the distance/temporal objective and relative-width objective independently in matrix form, with feasibility and nonnegative-multiplier KKT stationarity checks. The audit also checks concordance, threshold/orientation logic, and all four filling-path cases. The 148 rendered profiles retain zero pairwise merge-level error and have no failed complete topology signatures. Table S17 reports the primary-setting residuals; they are optimizer residuals, not layout-quality scores.

Table S17: Independent baseline audit. ST entries are maximum relative KKT residuals for the paper's first and second optimization problems under the current shared-input settings.

Data	Frames	TMTM decisions	Intervals/anchors	ST Eq.1	ST Eq.2	OLO gaps
Storms	118	285	687	3.55×10^{-8}	1.25×10^{-8}	1
Wildfires	30	201	431	1.89×10^{-8}	9.63×10^{-7}	7

Ordering heuristic. ST-MTM's stated SciPy OLO step is retained as a heuristic. With SciPy 1.13.1, independent exhaustive legal-order checks find larger adjacency costs in eight frames (Table S18); the implementation is not silently replaced by an exhaustive sorter. Subsequent temporal orientation and quadratic optimization follow their declared protocol. Author-code equivalence is not claimed for ST-MTM: the available preprint states that its complete implementation will be released after acceptance.

Table S18: All audited frames where the SciPy OLO adjacency cost exceeds the exhaustive legal-order minimum. Costs use the corresponding input-coordinate distance units.

Data	Frame	SciPy cost	Exhaustive minimum
Storms	24	182.717226	152.485568
Wildfires	0	134.960780	127.765618
Wildfires	1	185.488174	149.395419
Wildfires	3	211.222797	209.969161
Wildfires	8	302.781490	251.500432
Wildfires	10	256.211632	256.089992
Wildfires	11	254.944394	242.866054
Wildfires	17	226.294598	221.158409

Shared-input settings and original-paper settings. The main comparison uses an ST-MTM reimplementation under the shared-input protocol. Its dataset configuration differs from the original paper's configuration (Table S19). K has input-coordinate length units; frame counts, scalar preprocessing, and tree inputs also differ. The audit checks equations and constraints without substituting original-paper parameters or changing any reported result.

Table S19: Current ST-MTM comparison settings and reference-paper settings. N is layout raster length; λ is temporal weight.

Data	Protocol	Weights	K	r	λ	N	Start
Storms	Current	uniform	5.644221	0.95	0.5	4096	0
Storms	Reference	inverse	135	0.65	0.05	4096	40
Wildfires	Current	uniform	6.269531	0.95	0.5	2048	0
Wildfires	Reference	uniform	10	0.85	0.5	4096	5

Tangaroa provenance. The audit rechecks the bindings of the saved 201-frame independent verification. Four generic Tangaroa preset entries were corrected from split to join trees; the active original-grid 201-frame pipeline already used join trees and its saved results are unchanged. The same-value multiway-saddle separators disclosed in S6 remain a declared extension of the original binary-tree TMTM core. The 36–186 derived-node range and the absence of a completed real-3D ST-MTM layout run retain the scope stated in S6.

Evidence preservation. The audit's `validation.json` reports 177 protected numerical files unchanged. No scientific stage is rerun for this manuscript revision. The paper package includes the existing audit JSON, preset-correction record, event-correspondence JSON, per-case event evidence, and figure hashes in `evidence/event_case_revision/` and `figures/source/real_case_studies/`. The full local sources remain `results/baseline_audit_20261019/` and `results/real_case_studies/`; the manuscript's publication-size figure export records its frozen-input hashes separately.

S8 Revised Figure Evidence and Coordinate Semantics

S8.1 Source identities and selected frames

The feature-linked figures read frozen arrays in `results/real_case_studies/evidence/`. No feature extraction, layout construction, persistence change, or experiment is rerun. Storms frame 48 is the previously retained witness. Wildfires frame 18 maximizes hierarchy cost among above-trigger frames with a persistent three-frame triple and positive position gain and scalar cost, with earliest ties. Tangaroa frame 140 maximizes achieved P-to-R displacement reduction among above-trigger frames with a persistent triple and positive scalar cost. These descriptive selection rules emphasize visible mechanisms; all performance summaries remain the complete-sequence results.

The underlying rows identify extrema by retained leaf IDs and positive-overlap track IDs. A track born within the enlarged window begins there; no trace is extrapolated to an absent feature. All scalar values, anchor coordinates, and error summaries come from saved records. Markers use the processed-field extrema over the raw source observations or pre-TTK volume views.

Table S20: Selected-frame evidence. Position quantities are percentages of fixed reference extent; NMLE is percentage of the processed sequence range. Tangaroa H is a lower bound. These rows are separate cases, not a pooled mean.

Case/frame	Leaves	Packing	H	Max P	Max R20	Actual NMLE
Storms/48	5	0	8.4484	8.8665	0.8333	13.2079
Wildfires/18	10	0	13.9211	14.7545	2.6328	15.0944
Tangaroa/140	27	0.1827	≥ 13.7442	14.7605	1.0164	13.7502

Analytical cost and rendered measurement. The planar event JSON fields named `actual_max_merge_error` were populated from the filling routine's returned analytical δ^*, before the positive strict-extremum clearance. Direct all-pair checks on the saved complete columns give Storms frame 48: analytical 12.557166 hPa, measured 12.558173 hPa (13.207872% NMLE); Wildfires frame 18: analytical 0.635061777, measured 0.635062968 (15.094425% NMLE). The revised frame-level text and captions use the measurements. The original JSON and all 177 protected result files remain unchanged; the correction is documented in the revision checks. Sequence-level main tables already use the independently measured filling records.

S8.2 Coordinate transformations and display resolution

A temporal panel covering frames $l,\ldots,r-1$ maps frame t to $x = x_0 + (t-l+1/2)w/(r-l)$. Its vertical mapping is $y = y_0 + (b-v)h/(b-a)$ for the displayed ordinate range $[a,b]$. Complete maps use $[0,1]$; local windows explicitly label cropped ranges. TMTM and ST-MTM normalize their own native sample domains to this unit interval. Only RG maps identify that interval with the fixed directional reference. Dashed reference tracks appear only in RG panels.

The scalar images are nearest-neighbour displays of the frozen profiles. Tangaroa's cached 4096-row display may omit narrow extrema at nearby rows. Exact full-resolution anchors are therefore overlaid independently from the retained positions; they are not snapped to the preview colours. All Tangaroa metrics use the 131072-row outputs, not these previews.

Storms source layers use the existing geographic transformation and coastline, with each extremum transformed from its processed-grid position. Wildfires source layers retain the full $[0,120]^2$ domain, unsmoothed raw log-FRP observations, and the saved processed extrema. Main-paper Figure 7 uses a light yellow–orange–brown palette with unchanged linear normalization: processed maps use $[0,4.207268783]$ and raw snapshots use $[0,12.050886763]$. Artificial negative connection values use grey-blue. The five main-paper raw snapshots have equal domain scale, and track labels terminate at the last saved sample. The original three-frame comparison remains in S10. Additional source-view records are in `evidence/dimensional_results/source_views.json`. Palette and coordinate records are retained in `evidence/figure8_display/`. Three Tangaroa images come from `tangaroa_volumes.npz`, frames 139, 140, and 141. For the framed views in main-paper Figure 10, the same original-grid scalar frames are rendered with the original transfer function and an orthographic display camera yawed by 18° from the preceding view. One affine projection maps the volume, all eight domain corners, and the marked three-dimensional extrema to the image plane. The display camera and projected coordinates are retained in `evidence/figure9_display/`; the

original camera cache remains unchanged. Volume aspect and source-field aspect remain fixed. The accompanying editable markers remain separate from the scientific raster layers.

Table S21: Tangaroa frame-140 extrema and fixed-reference coordinates. Local feature IDs are original-grid vertex IDs.

Track	Leaf	x	y	z	Reference	R anchor
A/432	361559	−0.152676	0.118994	−0.489916	0.290592	0.280428
B/462	981499	0.315552	−0.196089	−0.469748	0.803567	0.813727
C/388	2674152	0.492809	0.011732	−0.417647	0.533667	0.543827

S8.3 Exact frontier and selected-order aggregation

Figure 5 averages exact per-frame frontiers under a common scalar budget: $\overline{F}(D) = T^{-1}\sum_t F_{T_t}(D)$. A selected-order working point uses $\overline{\tau} = T^{-1}\sum_t \tau(\pi_t)$ and $D_{\max} = \max_t \delta^*(\pi_t)$. Every selected order is feasible at $D_{\max}$, so $\overline{F}(D_{\max}) \le \overline{\tau}$. The plotted vertical gap quantifies search/order choice at that common budget. It does not compare a mean scalar error to a maximum budget, and it does not replace measured anchor residuals. At R20 the Storms point is $(26.0704\%, 1.5841\%L)$, whereas the common-budget attainable mean is $1.1068\%L$.

Figure S7(c) keeps the selected R20 orders fixed and averages original-LCA versus optimal scalar costs: Storms 2.0711% versus 1.4680%, Wildfires 4.6789% versus 3.9551%, and Ring 5.4579% versus 2.7289%. Main-table NMLE is independently measured after filling and includes strict-extremum clearance. Figure 4 is the supplied three-leaf schematic: A/B joins at s_1 and the outside leaf joins at s_2. For equal leaf values below their midpoint, order A, C, B gives original-LCA cost $s_2 - s_1$ and optimal cost $(s_2 - s_1)/2$. The former saved five-leaf profiles remain separate numerical evidence (LCA cost 5, optimal cost 2.5); they are no longer the source of Figure 4.

Additional archived sequence. The Storms 2013/14 panel in main-paper Figure 5 supplies an independent archived example. The complete six-sequence comparisons and the 339/342-frame frontier check use the active datasets defined in the evaluation protocol. OLR and PM2.5 remain included in those tables and checks.

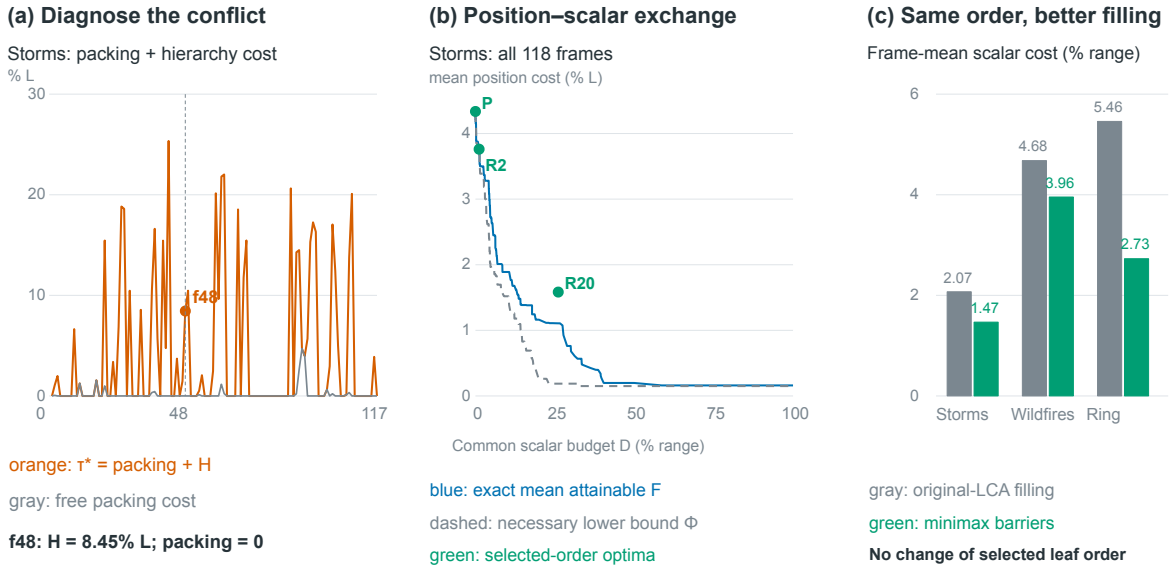


Figure S7: Additional certificate and filling diagnostics retained from the preceding revision. (a) Storms interval certificate, free packing cost, and the frame-48 hierarchy conflict. (b) Common-budget mean frontier and selected-order working points. (c) Mean original-LCA and optimal scalar costs for the same selected R20 orders. These supporting diagnostics accompany the five-panel main-paper frontier overview.

S8.4 Storms three-snapshot detail

The following retained four-method comparison complements Figure 1's RG-MTM-R20 overview and local tracks. It adds source snapshots at frames 47, 48, and 49 using identical colours and true extremum positions. Missing features are unmarked; $A = 60$ begins at frame 48. Baseline axes remain native layout ranks, and dashed references occur only in RG panels.

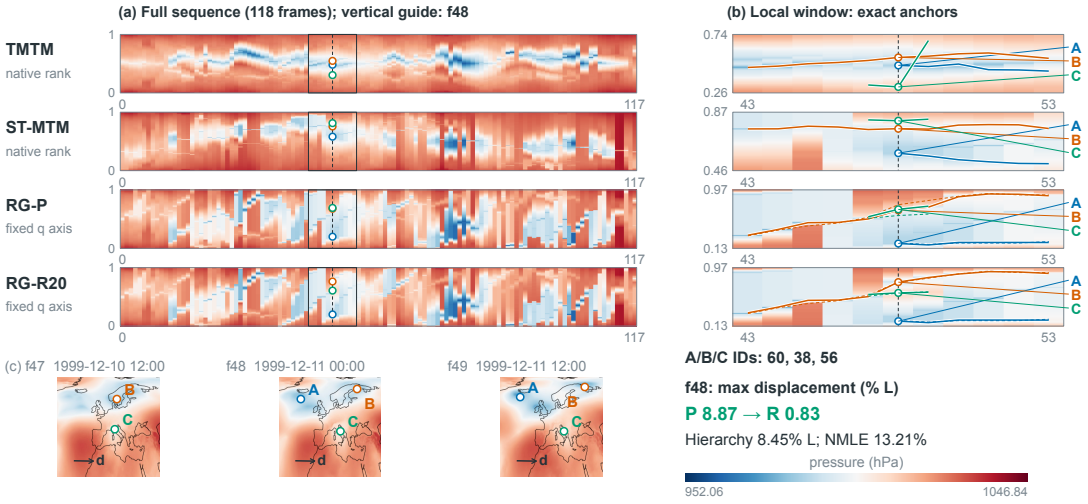


Figure S8: Storms detail for the 118-frame quantitative sequence: four layouts, the local conflict window, and raw source snapshots with saved processed extrema. Tracks $A = 60$, $B = 38$, and $C = 56$ refer to this sequence. Main-paper Figure 1 instead uses a separate 744-hour pressure-anomaly visualization with its own extracted features and track identifiers; the two populations and scalar preprocessing are distinct.

Storms eligibility and fixed-order scalar cost. At frame 48, the A/B node's parent gap is 15.314 hPa and meets the eligibility threshold $\kappa = 19.016$ hPa. Its half-gap lower bound is 7.657 hPa. Fixing C's extremum value at 1006.693 hPa raises the chosen order's analytical optimum to 12.557 hPa; strict-extremum clearance produces the independently measured 12.558 hPa error. These quantities respectively describe eligibility, a necessary bound, the fixed-order optimum, and the rendered result.

S8.5 Detailed measurements accompanying the Results section

Storms frame 48. Tracks $A = 60, B = 38, C = 56$ have normalized references 0.208, 0.759, 0.603. TMTM orders them C, A, B, ST-MTM/P use A, B, C, and R20 uses A, C, B. All-leaf NROE is 19.734%, 7.779%, 7.779%, and zero, respectively. Maximum P/R displacement is 8.867%/0.833% of L. Source merges are 994.136 hPa for A/B and 1009.449 hPa for either outside pair; R places all three at 1006.694 hPa.

Wildfires frames 17–19. Track $C = 52$ has fixed reference 0.418, P anchors 0.281, 0.549, 0.325, and R anchors 0.468, 0.422, 0.409. At frame 18, $A = 3, B = 48, C = 52$ have references 0.169, 0.685, 0.418. Hierarchy cost is 13.921%L; maximum P/R displacement is 14.754%/2.633%L. All-leaf NROE for TMTM/ST-MTM/P/R20 is 38.026%/38.026%/13.318%/1.587%. The A/B source level 0.060800 changes to -0.574262, giving worst-pair error 0.635063 and 15.094% actual NMLE.

Tangaroa frame 140. Tracks $A = 432, B = 462, C = 388$ have references 0.291, 0.804, 0.534 and source joins 0.713403 (A/B), 0.869923 (either outside pair). TMTM/P/R20 order them $C, A, B/A, B, C/A, C, B$, with all-leaf NROE 15.529%/13.495%/0.532%. Packing is 0.183%L, the hierarchy lower bound 13.744%L, and maximum P/R displacement 14.760%/1.016%L. R sets A/B to 0.988407 and A/C to 0.594919: worst-pair change 0.275004, or 13.750% actual NMLE.

S9 Additional Reference-Dataset Experiments

This section documents the Nucleon, Cylinder, and reconstructed Benzene additions independently of the 342-frame planar suite, the 744-hour Storms visualization, the 64-frame mirror control, and the 201-frame Tangaroa experiment. Existing measurements and figures are retained. Saved result records and their SHA-256 bindings are packaged under `evidence/additional_datasets/`. Every new dataset has `status=complete_verified`; complete-map verification covers 5 Nucleon maps, 510 Cylinder maps, and 105 Benzene maps.

S9.1 Data correspondence and coverage

Table S22: Correspondence with the six dataset families in TMTM. Coverage of a family does not imply identical final author inputs.

Name	Current input	Correspondence / scope
Nucleon	64×64, 1 slice	Original author padded slice; static
Ring	14×14, 40 frames	Archived author generator
Storms	49×49, 744 hours	ERA5 anomaly overview; 118-frame statistics separate
Tangaroa	$300 \times 180 \times 120$, 201 volumes	Author source; declared speed and TTK protocol
Cylinder	$135 \times 64 \times 48$, 102 volumes	Public resampling; reference reports 508 frames
Benzene	61×61, 21 z sections	Reconstructed OPLS-AA electrostatic potential

The Benzene author potential file remains unavailable; the newly accepted reconstruction supplies a related scalar model rather than its original fractional-charge calculation. The earlier electron-density and two-dimensional circular-cylinder pilots are excluded. Cylinder remains a genuinely three-dimensional spatial input, while Benzene is a sequence of two-dimensional spatial sections of a static field.

S9.2 Shared construction and numerical scope

All five methods in each new experiment share the same processed fields, extracted extrema, supports, and overlap correspondences. They compare TMTM, RG-MTM-P, and RG-MTM-R at eligibility fractions 0.02, 0.20, and 1.00; ST-MTM was not run in these additions. The reference is fixed to the physical x axis. Scalar normalization uses one sequence-wide range, with no per-frame scalar normalization. NROE uses the full leaf population and NMLE is independently measured on complete saved profiles. A figure preview is not a metric input.

Nucleon and Cylinder use a join tree of the negated, scaled source scalar, equivalent to its split tree; displayed values recover the original sign and units. Benzene instead uses the positive, scaled potential and its join tree. A sign inversion is not silently reused across these datasets. The RG raster has 32768 rows; TMTM retains every input sample with its declared virtual saddle multiplicities. At most four declared legal orders enter the secondary convex optimization. Relaxation pruning is disabled; bounds and finite candidate sets do not imply global secondary optimality.

Independent verification checks scalar transforms, augmented-tree sample ownership and monotone arcs, parent-chain LCAs, full-map barriers, TMTM sample multiplicities, and RG hard constraints. Cylinder additionally recomputes all three-dimensional Q values using an independent Amira parser and the rotation/strain Frobenius-norm identity. Benzene recomputes all 78,141 source-potential samples using scalar distances and `math.fsum`; saved float32 source values agree exactly. Native TTK still supplies persistence simplification, which is not independently reimplemented by these audits. No new claim about cross-hardware runtime or perceptual accuracy is made.

S9.3 Nucleon protocol

The source is the TMTM author's padded uint8 centre slice from the archived author revision recorded in the packaged input protocol. It is used without smoothing, spatial resampling, or persistence removal. Scalar range is 247, and $x, y = 0, \ldots, 63$. The extracted input has 13 leaves and 26 nodes versus 28 nodes in the reference table. This mismatch is retained rather than tuning the input to match the published count. All three R maps are exactly equal to the saved P array. One static slice cannot support temporal or volumetric claims.

S9.4 Benzene reconstructed potential

The declared 12-site vacuum Coulomb model is $V(r) = \sum_i q_i / \|r - R_i\|$, with six carbon charges $-0.115e$ and six hydrogen charges $+0.115e$ from Table 1, page 67 of the BOSS 4.9 manual [7]. The public Inviwo molecular cube supplies atomic coordinates only [6]; no electron-density samples are interpreted as potential. Coordinates are in bohr and potential is in Hartree/e. No softening radius, clipping, smoothing, charge fitting, or post hoc symmetry enforcement is applied. The minimum grid-to-charge distance is 0.0519513 bohr, so the sampled grid avoids singularities. The model, geometry, and domain were fixed before layout comparison.

Each 61×61 section spans $[-6,6]^2$, and 21 parallel sections span $z = -2, -1.8, \ldots, 2$. The signed potential is divided by one fixed range 3.92116975784 before join-tree extraction. Traditional persistence simplification uses 0.05% of each section's range. There are 5–10 leaves and 10–20 nodes, versus the reference table's 14–68 nodes. Four leaf extrema lie on the rectangular boundary in every section. An interior-extremum diagnostic uses only the 15 sections with at least two interior leaves; this is distinct from whether a leaf's support touches the boundary. Full-population results remain primary.

The source geometry is nearly planar rather than exactly planar: the maximum $\pm z$ source-field discrepancy is 0.0241% of the sequence range. The map mirror diagnostic compares ten $\pm z$ pairs at the same 32768 common map coordinates, without a fitted reflection or alignment. Adjacent-section displacement residual is the absolute difference between displayed anchor change and projected-source change divided by domain width; all methods share 170 overlap matches. These quantities measure section coherence and approximate reflection, not physical molecular motion. Figure 9 uses a common coolwarm symmetric-log display, linear inside ± 0.0784234 a.u., with fixed endpoints ± 2.20763588 a.u. The display does not change scalar arrays. TMTM is not optimized for the prescribed x reference; its NROE is a reference-compatibility diagnostic rather than its original objective.

S9.5 Cylinder input, motion, and rendering

The velocity archive is the public uniformly resampled square-cylinder simulation credited to Camarri, Salvetti, Buffoni, and Iollo [1, 14, 15]. Spatial derivatives use physical coordinates on the full $192 \times 64 \times 48$ source grid. Only afterward are source x indices 57–191 retained, giving $x \in [-2.45026178, 20]$, $y \in [-4, 4]$, and $z \in [0, 6]$. All 102 archive members are used. There is no smoothing, downsampling, or leaf-count filtering. The source is spanwise-periodic, but this implementation does not connect the z endpoints: it uses second-order one-sided derivatives at boundaries and marks boundary-touching features. This treatment and the 102-versus-508-frame difference limit equivalence to the original paper's final Q fields.

Persistence simplification uses 2% of each source frame's range. The fixed sequence scalar scale is 25.8113212585. The retained trees have 8–150 nodes and 4–75 leaves. Motion uses overlap-linked extrema, a two-step window, and a 2%-of-domain-diagonal change threshold for three-dimensional truth. The projected diagnostic uses 2% of the x extent and has its own clear-event population. Error counts and exact projection are given below. Neither diagnostic is a physical vortex-label ground truth.

The maps use the saved 2048-row previews with no additional point or trajectory overlay. Coolwarm is normalized by a shared symmetric logarithm, linear inside $[-0.02, 0.02]$, with fixed endpoints ± 20.4634399414. Main Figure 11 shows raw source isosurfaces at $Q = 0.1$ and 0.5 for the fixed first, middle, and last snapshots (frames 0, 51, 101). Marching cubes uses the original physical grid and no smoothing. The camera is orthographic, elevation 22°, azimuth $-65°$; physical aspect, levels, and opacity are fixed across all views. Native domain edges project the same eight physical corners. These source views precede TTK simplification, while the maps show the common processed scalar and method-specific filling. Rendering records and source-frame hashes are in `evidence/additional_datasets/render_metadata.json`.

S9.6 Complete two-dimensional measurements

Table S23: Nucleon static input: complete saved configuration comparison. NROE and NMLE are percentages.

Method	NROE	NMLE mean	NMLE max	Exact-topology frames
TMTM	11.9048	0.0000	0.0000	1/1
RG-MTM-P	2.3810	0.0000	0.0000	1/1
RG-MTM-R2	2.3810	0.0000	0.0000	1/1
RG-MTM-R20	2.3810	0.0000	0.0000	1/1
RG-MTM-R100	2.3810	0.0000	0.0000	1/1

Table S24: Benzene 21 reconstructed-potential sections: complete saved configuration comparison. NROE and NMLE are percentages.

Method	NROE	NMLE mean	NMLE max	Exact-topology frames
TMTM	50.0000	0.0000	0.0000	21/21
RG-MTM-P	4.2063	0.0000	0.0000	21/21
RG-MTM-R2	0.0000	0.0025	0.0080	6/21
RG-MTM-R20	0.0000	0.0025	0.0080	6/21
RG-MTM-R100	0.0000	0.0025	0.0080	6/21

Table S25: Benzene boundary and section-coherence diagnostics, all in percent. Interior NROE uses 15 eligible sections; residual uses 170 adjacent-section matches; mirror MAE uses ten section pairs. The full-population table above remains primary.

Method	Interior NROE	Displacement residual	Mirror-map MAE
TMTM	12.5000	2.7546	0.0185
RG-MTM-P	5.8889	1.2191	0.0064
RG-MTM-R2	0.0000	0.1373	0.0030
RG-MTM-R20	0.0000	0.1373	0.0030
RG-MTM-R100	0.0000	0.1373	0.0030

S9.7 Complete three-dimensional measurements

Table S26: Cylinder 102 three-dimensional fields: complete saved configuration comparison. NROE and NMLE are percentages.

Method	NROE	NMLE mean	NMLE max	Exact-topology frames
TMTM	26.6169	0.0000	0.0000	102/102
RG-MTM-P	12.2622	0.0000	0.0000	102/102
RG-MTM-R2	0.2488	0.6919	4.8865	8/102
RG-MTM-R20	0.0841	2.8096	14.2811	5/102
RG-MTM-R100	0.0841	3.1901	14.2811	5/102

Table S27: Cylinder motion proxies. Three-dimensional truth has 3196 clear events; projected truth has 2934. Counts show reversal + miss. Exact projection has no rendered scalar topology and is a reference control.

Method	3D count	3D error (%)	Projected count	Projected error (%)
TMTM	845+1296	66.990	867+978	62.883
RG-MTM-P	598+593	37.265	510+360	29.652
RG-MTM-R2	76+541	19.305	0+123	4.192
RG-MTM-R20	71+534	18.930	0+108	3.681
RG-MTM-R100	72+534	18.961	0+107	3.647
Exact x projection	69+534	18.867	0+0	0.000

Optimization records.

Dataset	Max. bracket / L	QP gap / L^2	Failed QPs
Nucleon	1.926×10^{-10}	8.382×10^{-8}	0
Cylinder	0.00830968	7.037×10^{-6}	0
Benzene	1.985×10^{-10}	8.957×10^{-7}	0

A finite certificate gap remains on some Cylinder cases. Verification establishes the stated saved-map and feasibility checks rather than exact continuous optimality of every certificate or a global optimum over all secondary orders.

S10 Complete Visual Comparisons and Hierarchical Ordering

The main paper focuses on RG-MTM-P/R and their source fields. This section retains the complete shared-input comparisons with TMTM and ST-MTM, additional source sections, and the clustering-hierarchy example. All panels use the same frozen scientific arrays as the main results. The baselines are local reimplementations, rather than images copied from the reference publications.

S10.1 Two-dimensional inputs and controls

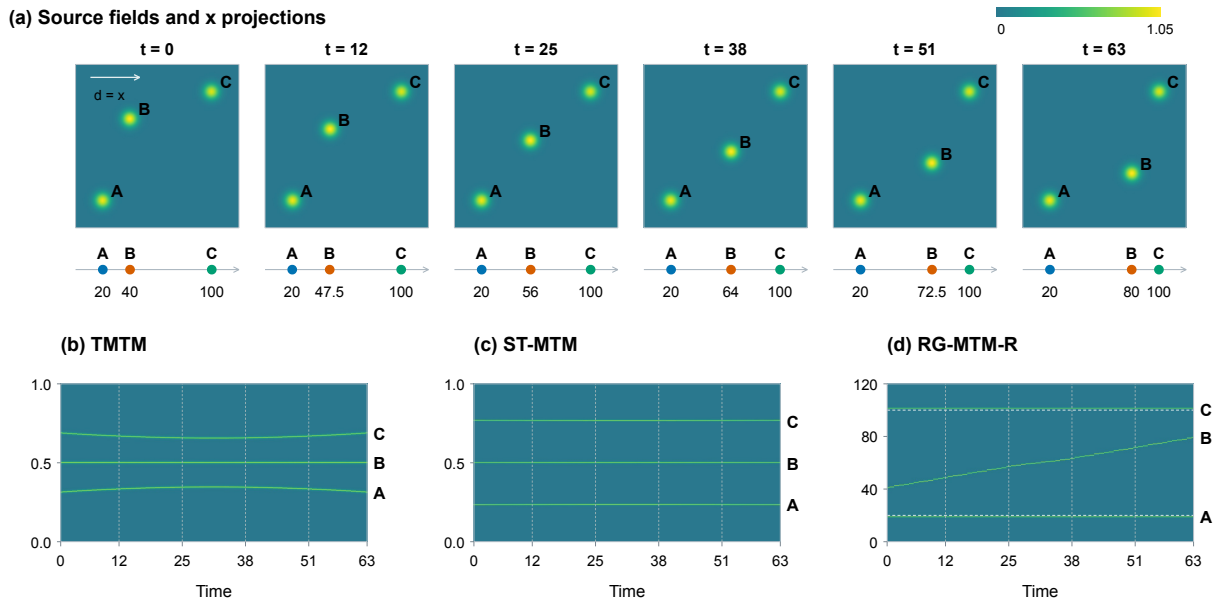


Figure S9: Relative distances and absolute reference position. (a) Six source fields and x projections follow moving B between fixed A, C; mirror endpoints preserve pairwise distances while changing horizontal position. (b,c) TMTM/ST-MTM use internal map coordinates. (d) RG-MTM-R uses source x units, with dashed fixed references. Source peaks and temporal bands share a linear 0–1.05 scalar scale. Vertical guides mark source-frame times. All three preserve merge levels; position errors and calibration are reported in the main paper's absolute-reference control.

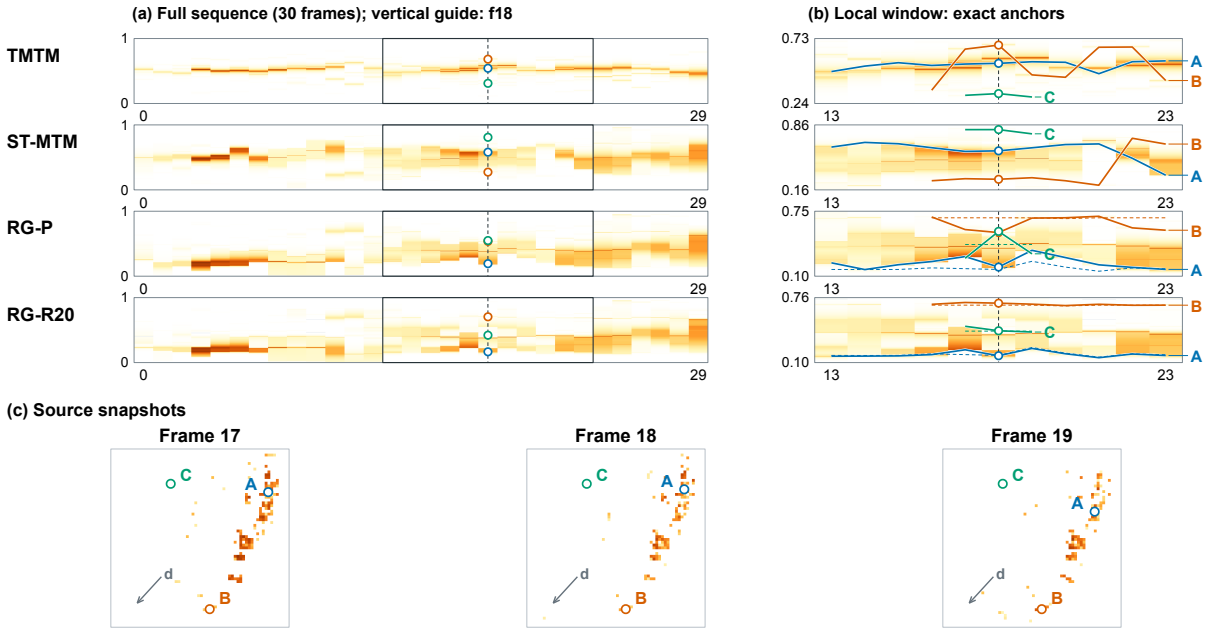


Figure S10: Wildfires source events and four layouts. Complete 30-frame maps (left) and frames 13–23 (right) share tracks $A = 3$, $B = 48$, $C = 52$. Circles and solid traces show saved anchors; dashed RG traces show references. Baseline axes are native rank; RG axes use the fixed projection. Local ordinate ranges are labelled. Bottom: raw source snapshots at frames 17–19, with processed extrema at true coordinates. At frame 18, P/R maximum displacement is 14.75%/2.63% of reference extent, at 15.09% actual R NMLE. A yellow–orange–brown scale encodes log-FRP with fixed ranges 0–4.21 for processed maps and 0–12.05 for raw snapshots. Grey-blue denotes artificial negative connections.

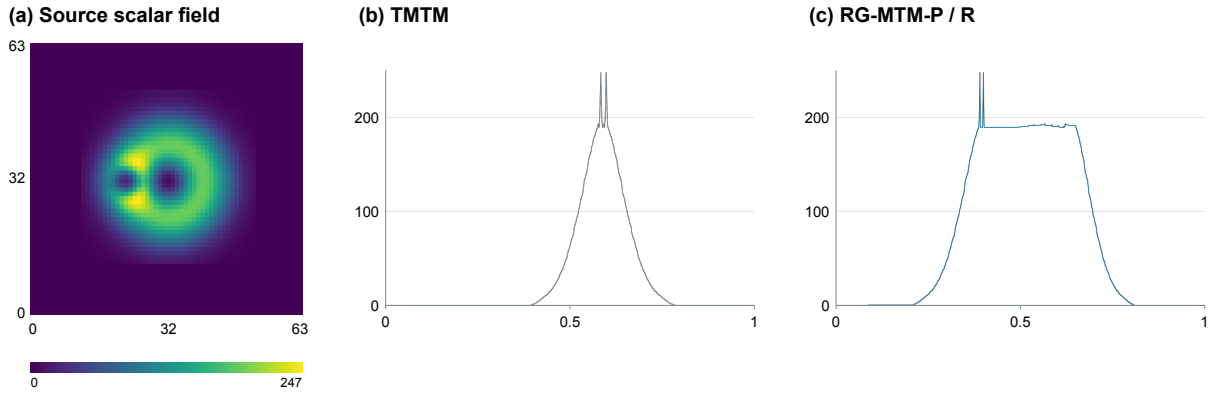


Figure S11: Nucleon static comparison. (a) The unchanged author 64×64 scalar slice. (b) Complete TMTM profile (4096 samples). (c) Complete P profile (32768 samples); all three R profiles are exactly identical to P. The source and curves use the original scalar units. NROE decreases from 11.90% to 2.38%, with zero measured NMLE throughout. This single frame supplies no temporal-motion or three-dimensional result.

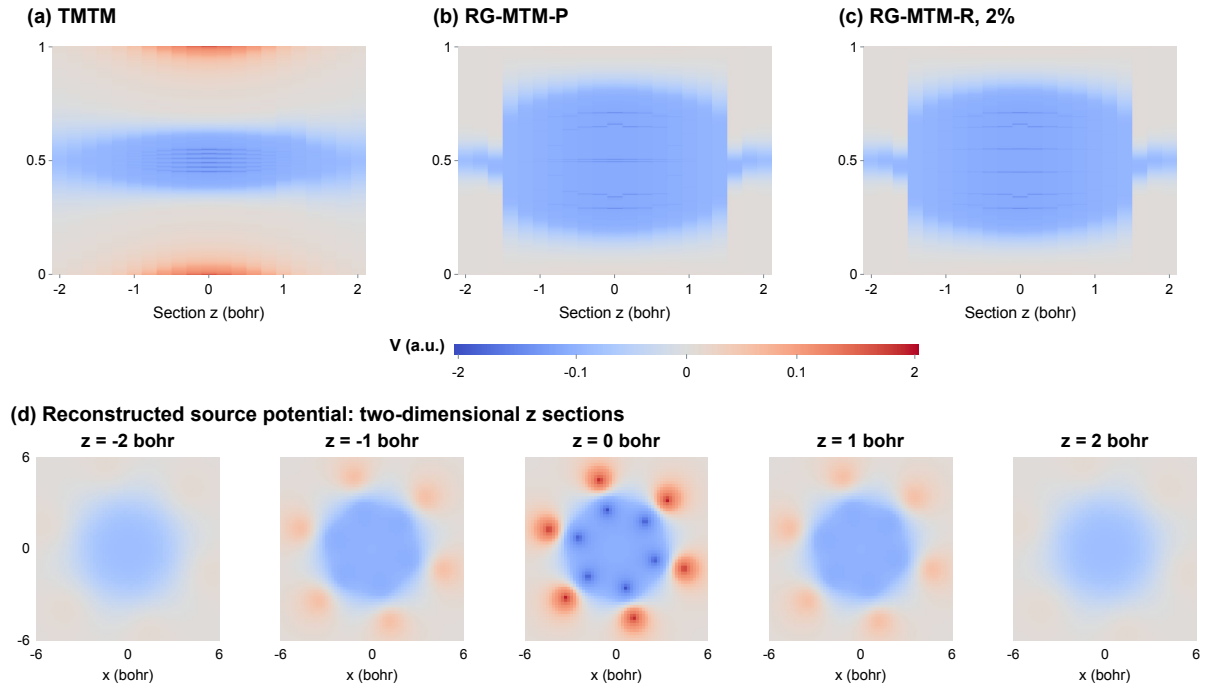


Figure S12: Benzene reconstructed electrostatic potential. (a)–(c) Maps of all 21 static z sections for TMTM, P, and R2; z is not physical time. TMTM uses its native map coordinate, while RG uses normalized x reference position. (d) Five 61×61 source-potential sections on the same symmetric-log colour scale (linear within ± 0.0784 a.u.). Values are in Hartree/e; source coordinates are in bohr. The field is the declared OPLS-AA point-charge reconstruction, not the original author's potential or electron density. Full-population scores retain four boundary extrema per section; internal-extremum diagnostics are reported separately.

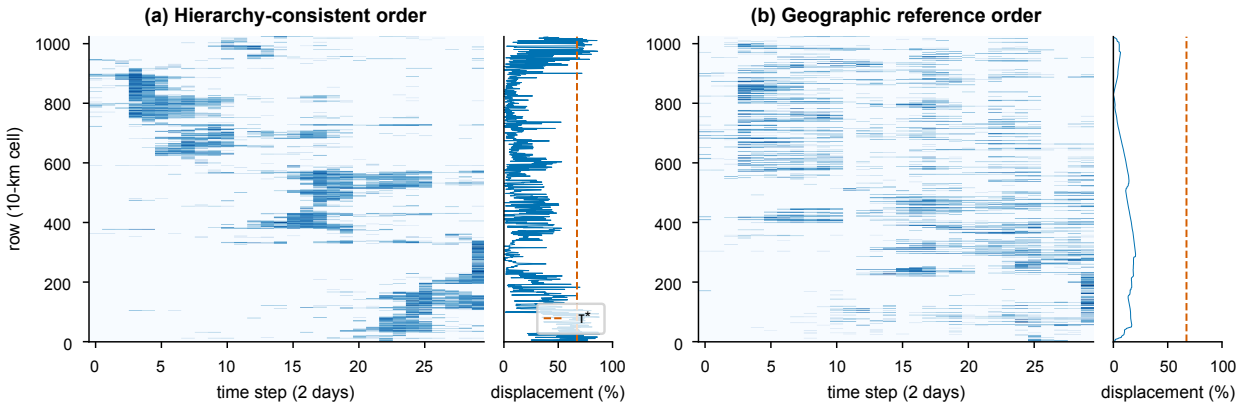


Figure S13: Position certification for a clustering hierarchy of 1024 active wildfire cells. The same 30 two-day $\log(1+\mathrm{FRP})$ observations are arranged in dendrogram-consistent optimal leaf order (a) and in geographic reference order (b). Blue encodes signal magnitude; each cell occupies one row. Side panels show absolute displacement from the cell's principal-axis geographic reference, normalized by 1024 rows. The dashed line marks the hierarchy-constrained optimum $\tau^* \approx 67.29\%$ (computed to 0.25 row). Observed maxima are 88.23% for OLO and 20.55% for geographic sorting, the free-packing optimum. Their separation distinguishes ordering choice from the additional cost imposed by hierarchy.

The positional certificate extends to clustering hierarchies in dense temporal displays. Figure S13 arranges 1024 active 10-km wildfire cells [4], each as one row containing 30 two-day $\log(1+\mathrm{FRP})$ observations. Average-linkage clustering of centered, unit-normalized temporal signals defines the dendrogram; optimal leaf ordering (OLO) groups similar signals within its legal orders. Reference positions project cell locations onto the principal geographic axis and span row centers 0.5–1023.5. Both panels contain the same observations and use identical row widths and color mapping.

OLO groups temporally similar activity into visible bands but displaces some cells by 88.23% of display height. Positional diagnosis over all dendrogram-consistent orders gives $\tau^*/n \approx 67.29\%$, where $n = 1024$. The approximately 20.94-percentage-point gap separates the chosen ordering's displacement from the minimum imposed by this hierarchy: changing the leaf-ordering algorithm can improve position, while subtree contiguity still prevents accurate geographic placement.

Geographic sorting removes the contiguity constraints and attains $\tau_{\mathrm{free}}/n = 20.55\%$. Equal-width rows fill the canvas, so nonuniform geographic references still incur packing cost. The hierarchy contributes the additional $H/n = (\tau^* - \tau_{\mathrm{free}})/n \approx 46.73\%$ of display height, or 46.73 percentage points beyond packing. Together with the mirror control, this distinguishes two sources of positional ambiguity: distances alone do not fix absolute references, and a fixed hierarchy can obstruct those references even under optimal positional ordering. The row experiment transfers positional diagnosis to a 1024-leaf clustering tree; the merge-tree experiments quantify scalar correction and relaxation costs. Supplement S3 gives the numerical precision and retained records.

S10.2 Three-dimensional inputs

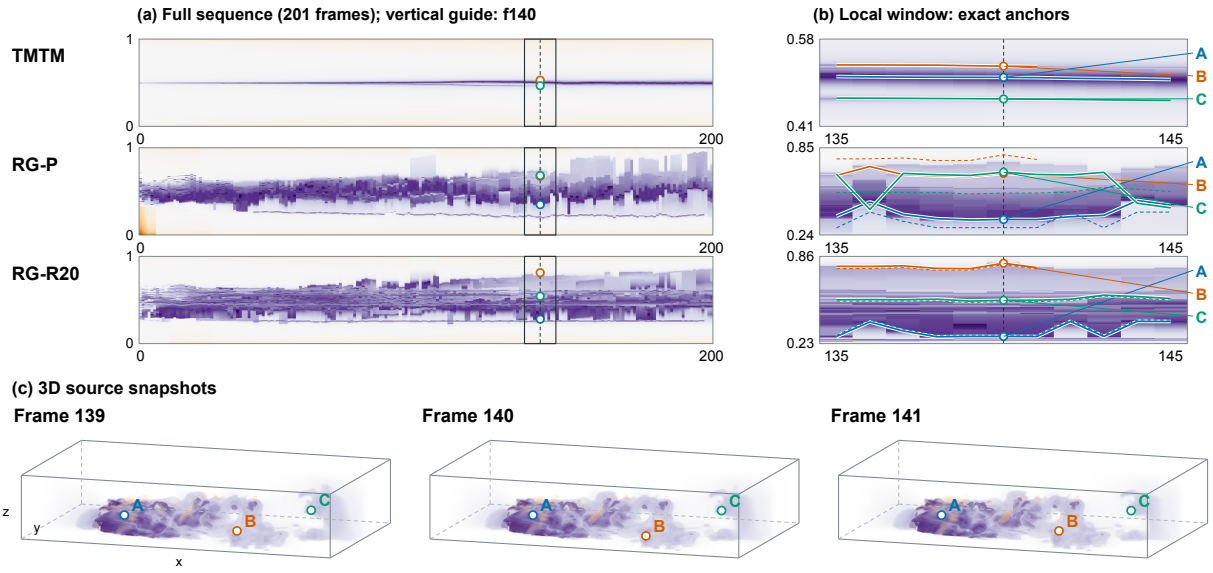


Figure S14: Tangaroa feature correspondence: all 201 original-grid frames at fixed 10% persistence. Complete TMTM/P/R20 maps (left) link to frames 135–145 (right); tracks $A = 432$, $B = 462$, $C = 388$ use exact saved anchors and dashed RG references. Baseline and RG ordinates retain their distinct meanings. Bottom: cached full-volume views at frames 139–141, with domain boxes and true extrema projected through one shared oblique orthographic camera. Preview layers use 4096 rows; errors use complete 131072-row profiles. At frame 140, P/R maximum displacement is 14.76%/1.02%, and R incurs 13.75% NMLE. Maps and volumes use the original authors' purple–white–orange speed transfer function over $[0,2]$.

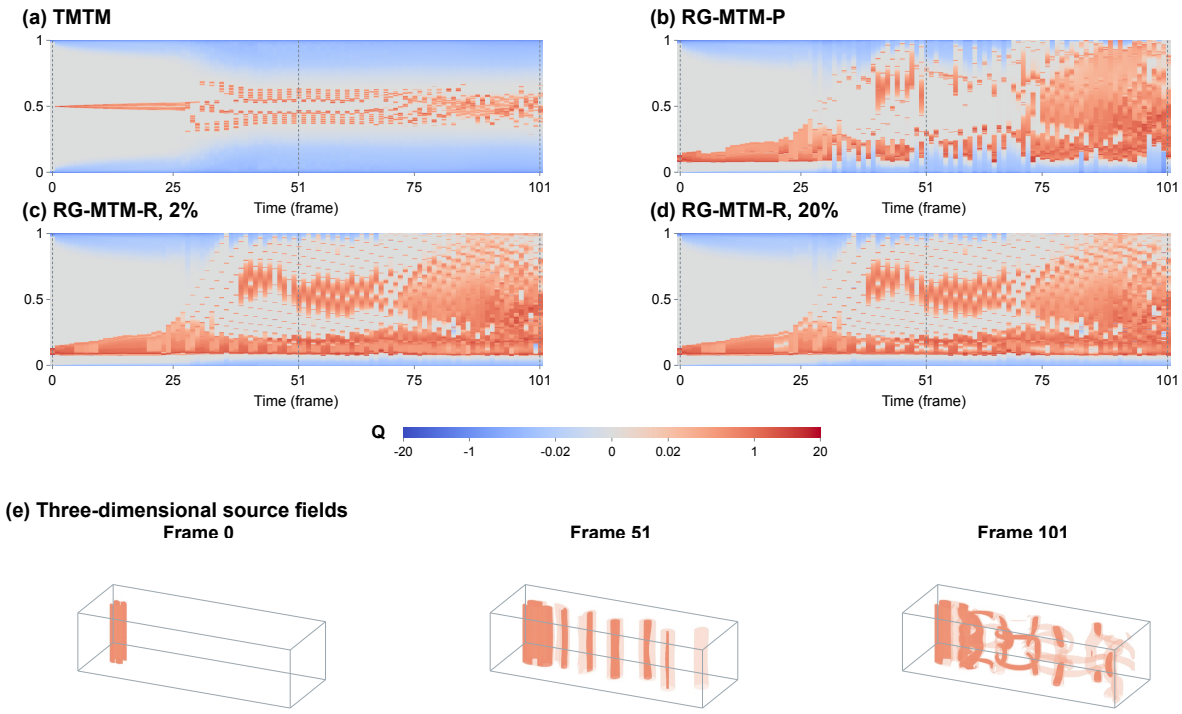


Figure S15: Cylinder: 102 original-grid three-dimensional Q fields. (a)–(d) Saved scalar maps for TMTM, P, R2, and R20; TMTM uses a native ordinate, while RG uses normalized physical x reference position. Dashed guides locate frames 0, 51, and 101. The common symmetric-log colour scale is linear within ± 0.02; metrics use complete profiles rather than these 2048-row previews. (e) Three-dimensional source isosurfaces at $Q = 0.1$ (translucent) and 0.5 (solid), with identical physical aspect, orthographic camera, and domain frame. They show the source Q before persistence simplification; maps use the shared simplified inputs and their stated scalar fillings.

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